AI-Powered Fire Prediction Spread and Containment System

User Manual

Panic! At The Kernel
Client: EPI-USE Africa

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1 Introduction

Fire Away is an AI-powered fire spread prediction system that uses real-time weather data, environmental conditions, and user reported fire locations to simulate fire progression and support emergency responders with early warnings and real-time strategic containment guidance.

2 Getting Started

2.1 Key features

- **Live Fire Map View:** View active fires near you based on your current location.
- **Reporting an Active Fire:** Report an active fire at a specific location including an image upload of the fire.
- **Firefighter Dashboard:** Aids firefighters in keeping track of changing weather and environmental conditions as well as active fires.
- **Interactive AI-Powered Fire Spread Simulation:** With the help of our AI model, watch how a fire can spread based on environmental factors and test how the fire can be contained.
- **Admin Analytics Dashboard:** Keep track of how many users are registered on the app and approvals.

2.2 Accessing Fire Away

Fire away is currently accessible at https://fireaway.csml.co.za/ on your desktop browser and can be downloaded as a PWA.

3 User Roles and Responsibilities

3.1 Admin

Administrators oversee the system, user access, fire report record-keeping and manual verification and rejection. Their responsibilities include:

- Approving or rejecting registration requests for the Administrator role.
- Managing user roles: approving/rejecting role requests (for admin and firefighters), searching users, and revoking access.
- Maintaining the searchable incident archive, into which closed fire incidents are automatically moved.
- Manually verifying or rejecting pending fire reports.

Access Permissions Granted:

1. Admin Dashboard
2. Live Fire Map
3. Role Approval
4. Report a Fire
5. View All Reported Fires

6. Register Resources
7. View All Registered GPUs
8. Volunteer a GPU (if applicable)
9. AI Fire Spread Simulation
10. Push Notifications
11. Help Menu

3.2 Firefighter

Firefighters are the field responders, using tactical tools for fire containment efforts and inform the AI simulation. Their responsibilities include:

- Monitoring the tactical dashboard, which displays fire direction, high-risk areas, wind conditions, and AI-recommended containment locations.
- Logging containment lines on the live map, triggering an automatic simulation re-run to reflect field actions.
- Operating with a live GPS position indicator on the map during active incidents.
- Accessing cached map data and the most recent spread prediction while offline, to maintain situational awareness in low-connectivity areas.
- Manually verifying or rejecting pending fire reports.

Access Permissions Granted:

1. Firefighter Dashboard
2. View All Reported Fires
3. Report a Fire
4. AI Fire Spread Simulation
5. Register a Resource
6. View All Registered GPUs
7. Volunteer a GPU
8. Push Notifications
9. Help Menu

3.3 Registered User

Registered Users are members of the public who have created an account to receive awareness. Their responsibilities include:

- Submitting fire reports and will receive status updates on their own reports.
- Receiving proximity-based push notifications when a fire is in close proximity to them.
- Viewing the AI-generated spread-prediction overlay on the live map, which is not available to guests.

Access Permissions Granted:

1. Live Fire Map
2. Report a Fire
3. Register a Resource
4. AI Fire Spread Prediction
5. Push Notifications
6. Help Menu

3.4 Guest

Guests (Anonymous visitors) interact with the system without creating an account. Their responsibilities include:

- Viewing the live fire map (including verified fire markers) without logging in.
- Submitting a fire report without an account.

Access Permissions Granted:

1. Live Fire Map
2. Report a Fire
3. Help Menu

4 Account Management

4.1 Sign-in as a Guest

Visitors who do not want to create an account can sign in as a guest user immediately.

- Navigate to the Fire Away login page.
- Select the **'Sign in as Guest'** button beneath the Login and Register options.

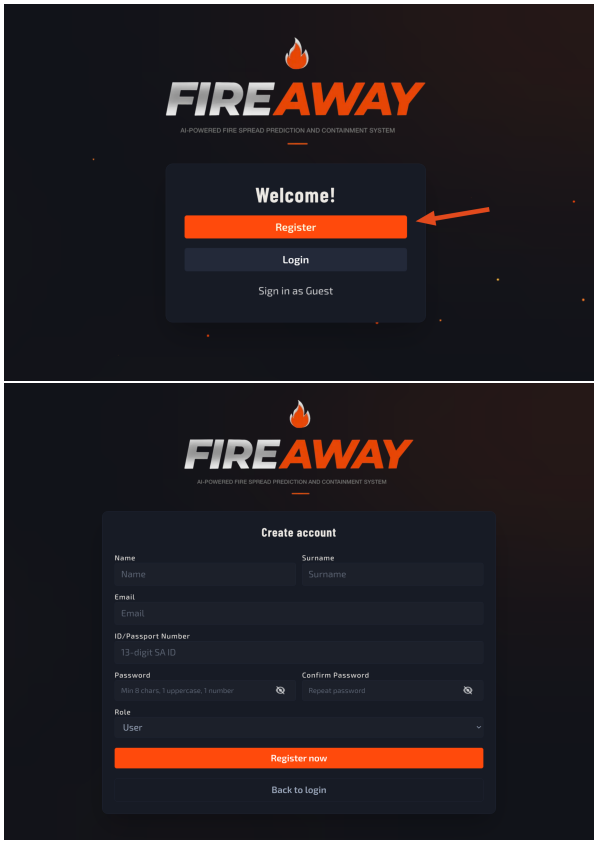
- From there, you will be taken directly to the Guest Dashboard, where you can view the live public fire map without needing to provide any credentials.

As a Guest, no personal information is collected and no session cookie tied to an account is created. You retain full access to the live fire map and fire reporting tools described in Section **??**, but you will not receive proximity notifications.

4.2 Registering

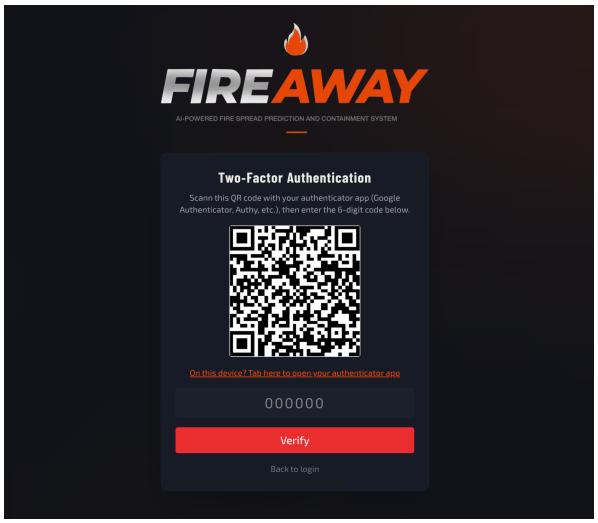
To create an account, navigate to the login page and select **"Register."** The registration form requires the following information:

- **Name** and **Surname**
- **Email address** – must be a valid email format
- **ID/Passport Number** – a 13-digit South African ID number
- **Password** – at least 8 characters, including at least one uppercase letter and one number
- **Confirm Password** – must match the password entered above
- **Role** – choose between *User* and *Firefighter*



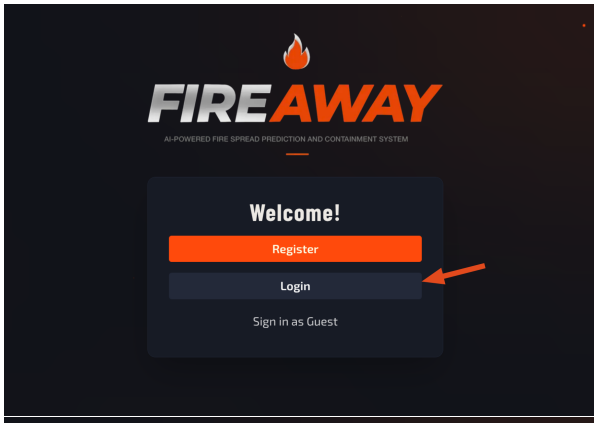
All fields are validated as you type, and any errors (such as a mismatched password or an invalid ID number) are shown directly beneath the relevant field before the form can be submitted.

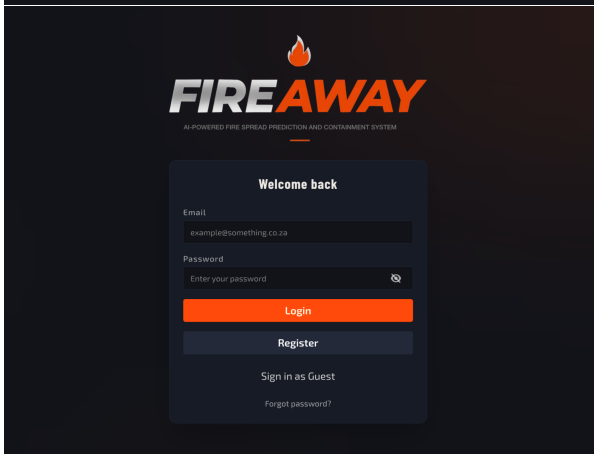
Once the form is submitted successfully, you will be redirected to a two-factor authentication (2FA) setup page, where you can scan a QR code to link an authenticator app to your new account. If registration fails – for example, because the email address is already in use – an error message is displayed at the bottom of the form and no account is created.



4.3 Login

Returning users can log in from the main Fire Away login page by entering their registered **email** and **password**. Both fields are validated before submission: the email must be correctly formatted, and the password must be at least 6 characters long.

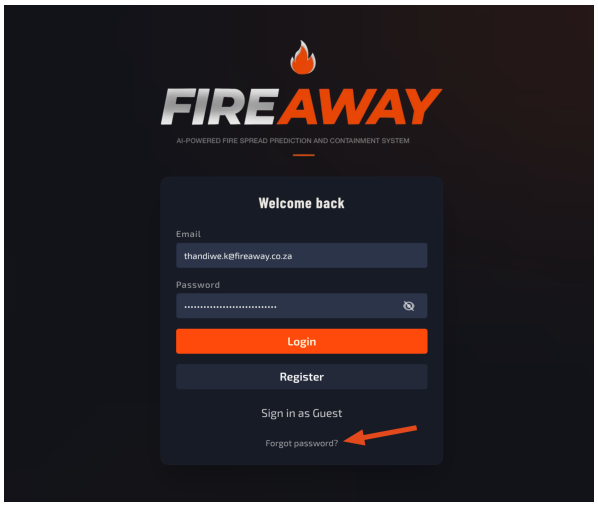




Once your credentials are submitted:

- If two-factor authentication is required on your account, you will be redirected to a verification page to enter your one-time passcode.
- If login is successful, you are automatically redirected to the dashboard matching your account role – the Admin dashboard, the Firefighter dashboard, or the Registered User dashboard.
- If the email or password is incorrect, an error message is displayed below the form and you remain on the login page.

If you have forgotten your password or are otherwise unable to log in, the **"Forgot password?"** and **"Can't log in?"** links beneath the login form will guide you through account recovery.



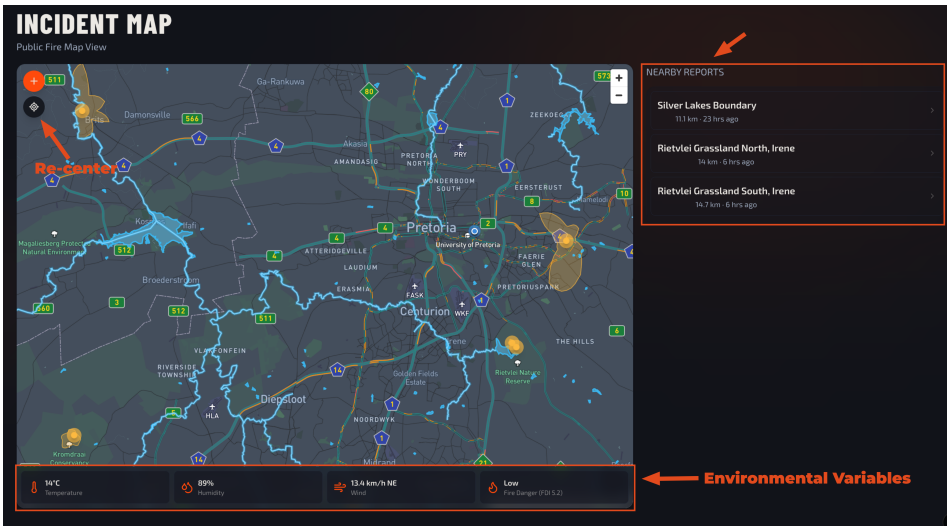
5 Live Fire Map

The Live Fire Map is the central public safety feature of Fire Away and is accessible to all users

When the page loads, Fire Away requests permission to use your device's location. If permission is granted, the map centers on your current position; otherwise, it falls back to a default location. The map itself shows active and verified fires in your surrounding area, refreshed automatically as new data becomes available.
Alongside the map, the dashboard displays two additional panels:

- **Environmental Variables** – current weather and environmental readings (such as wind and temperature) for your area, used as inputs to the fire-spread predictions.
- **Nearby Reports** – a scrollable list of fire reports submitted within a 20 km radius of your location, giving a quick overview of recent activity near you.

A **Recenter** action is available at any time, which re-requests your device's location and re-centers the map and nearby report list around your current position. If location access is unavailable, the map recenters on the system default location instead.

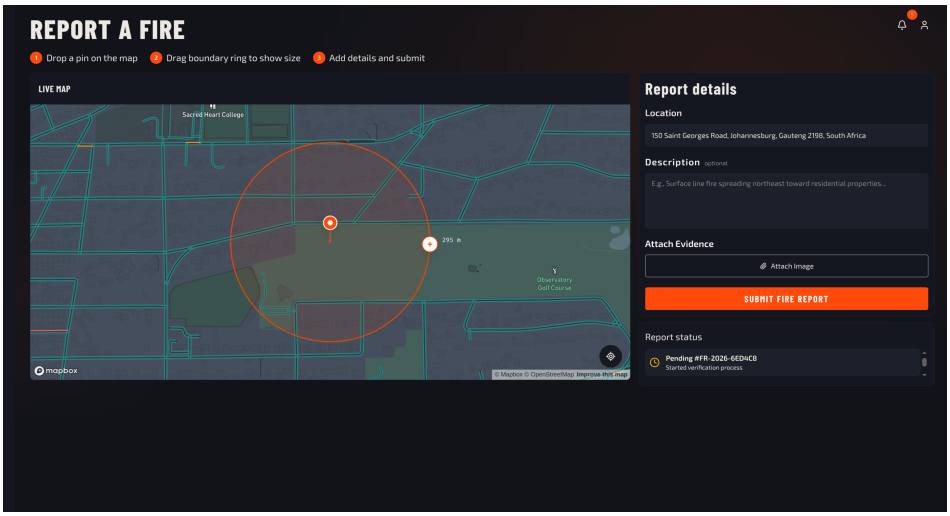


6 Reporting a Fire

All the roles have access to the Reporting a Fire page. The users are able to report a fire and add evidence of the fire to create a fire report. When it is submitted, the status is set to pending, and the fire report needs to go through the verification process, which is the verification algorithm, or it gets manually verified or rejected by an admin or firefighter. When it is verified, the report status is set to verified, and alerts will be sent out to the registered users in close proximity to the fire, and the fire map will be updated accordingly. The fire report's status is visible to the user on the report a fire page.

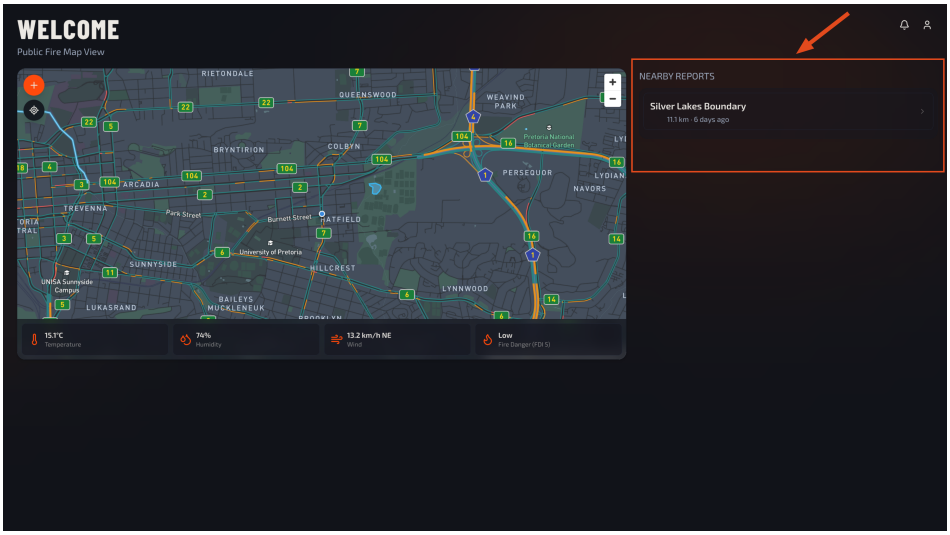
6.1 Reporting a fire

1. Click a location on the map or search the location in the search bar.
2. Adjust the circle to the approximate size of the fire.
3. The user has the option to add a description.
4. Upload a picture of the fire for evidence.
5. Click on the submit button to submit the fire report.
6. The fire report status changes visibly.



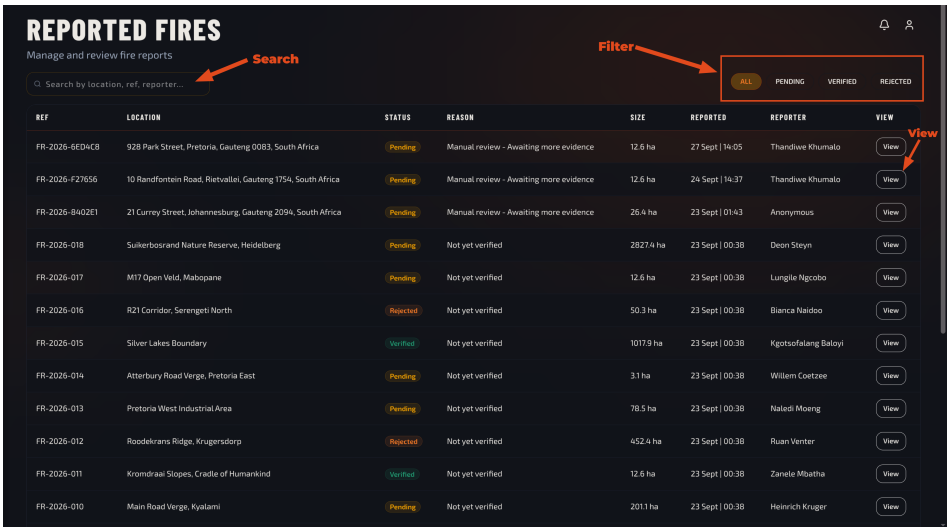
7 Nearby Fires

The Nearby Fires Panel is displayed on every user role's landing page/dashboard. This displays a list of active fires within a 20km radius of your current location.



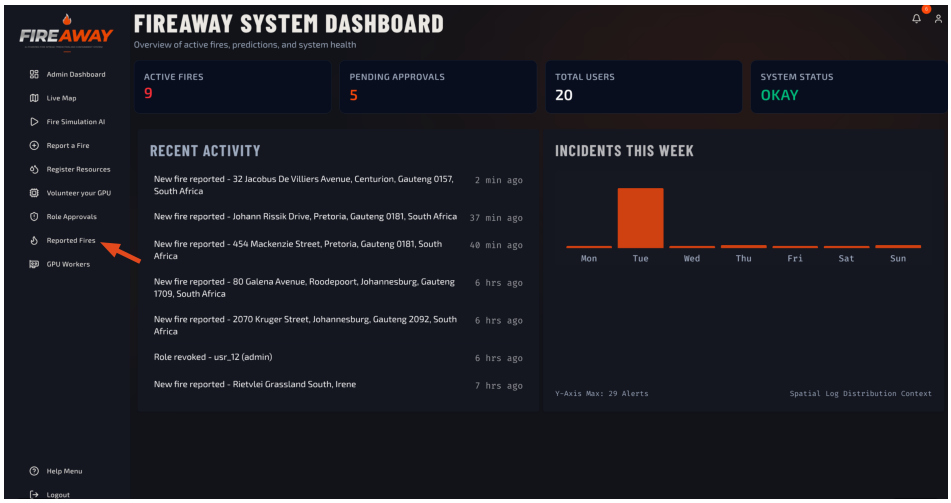
8 Reported Fires (Firefighter & Admin)

The Reported fires page shows all the reported fires in a table view. Admins and firefighters have access to this page. The reported fires can be filtered to All, Pending, Verified and Rejected by clicking on the labels. A specific reported fire can be searched for by location, reference, reporter etc. When clicking on the View button, a pop-up is shown with more details of the fire, including an image that the reporter added if he or she were so inclined. An admin or firefighter can then manually approve or reject a pending fire and they can revoke an approved status from a reported fire that has already been approved.

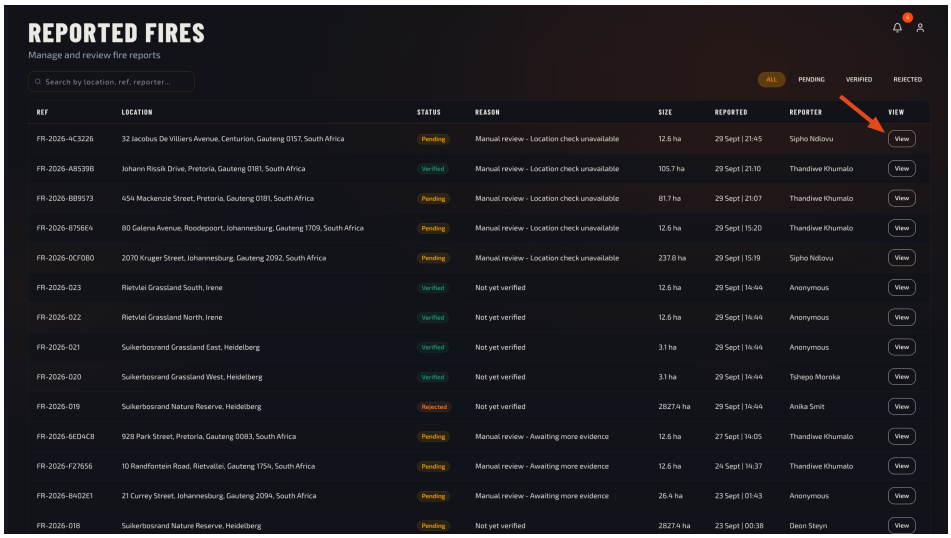


8.1 Managing a fire report

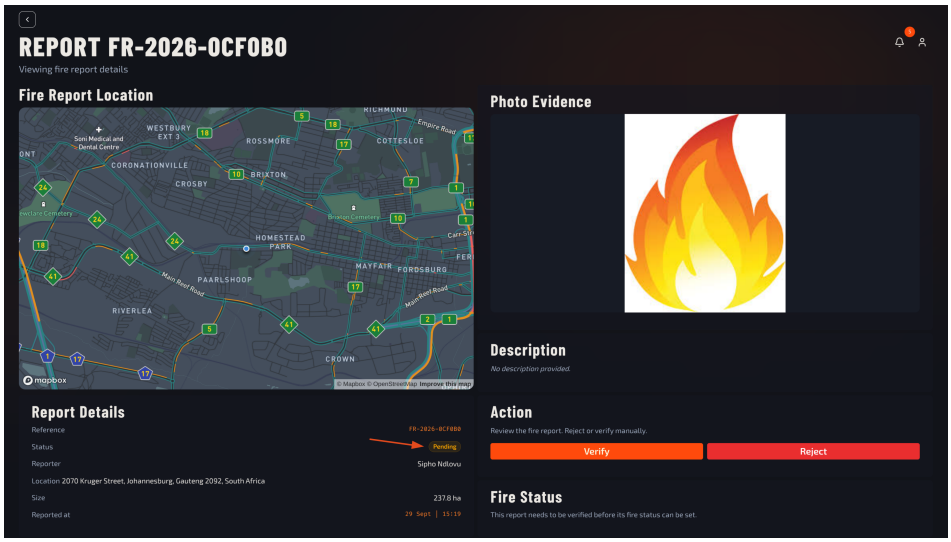
1. Open the Reported Fires page to view the table of all submitted fire reports.



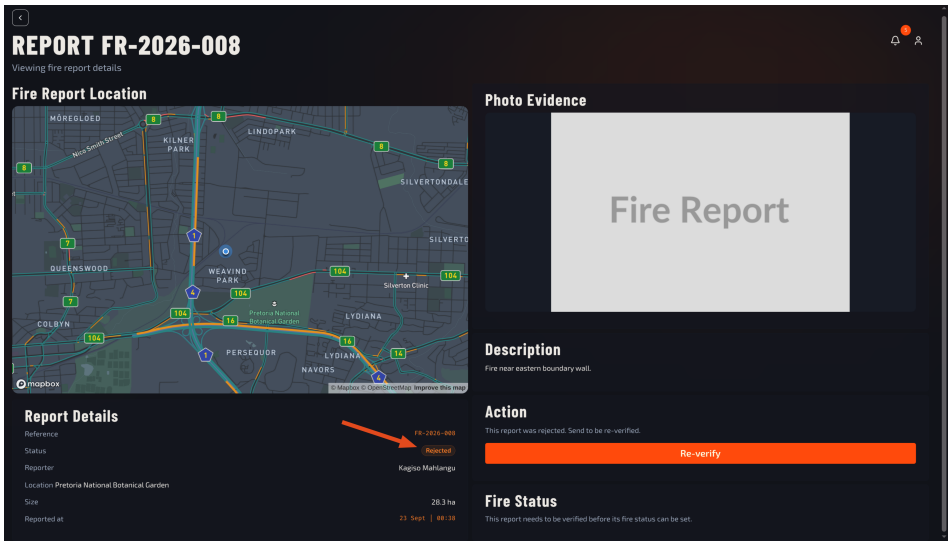
2. Click the **View** button on a report to open a pop up with more details, including the fire's location on the map and any image the reporter added as evidence.



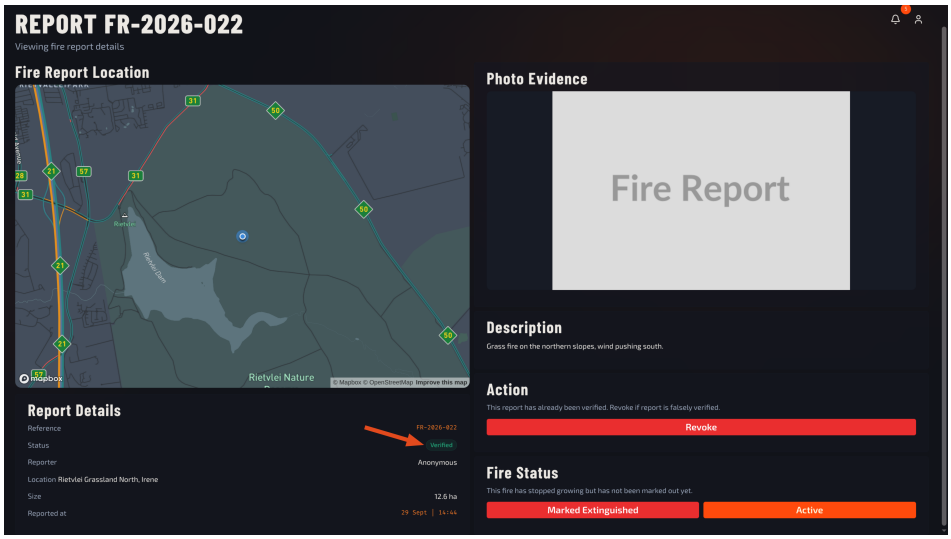
3. If the report is **Pending**, click **Verify** to manually approve it or **Reject** to decline it.



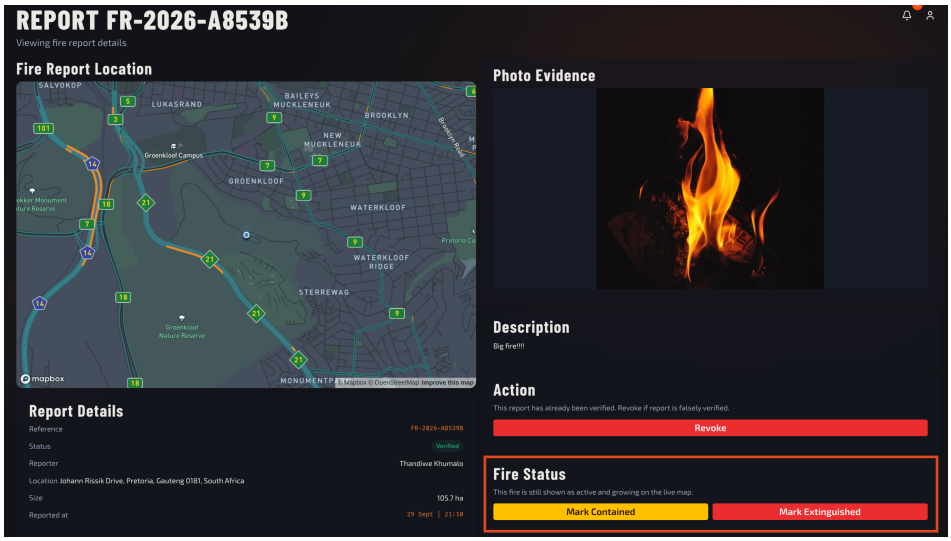
4. A report that has been **Rejected**, can be re-verified.



5. A report that has been **Verified**, can be rejected if the report proves to be false.



6. If a fire is **verified**, the status of the fire can be changed from **"Active"**, to **"Extinguished"**, or **"Contained"**, and vice versa. Changes to a fire status will reflect on the live fire map.

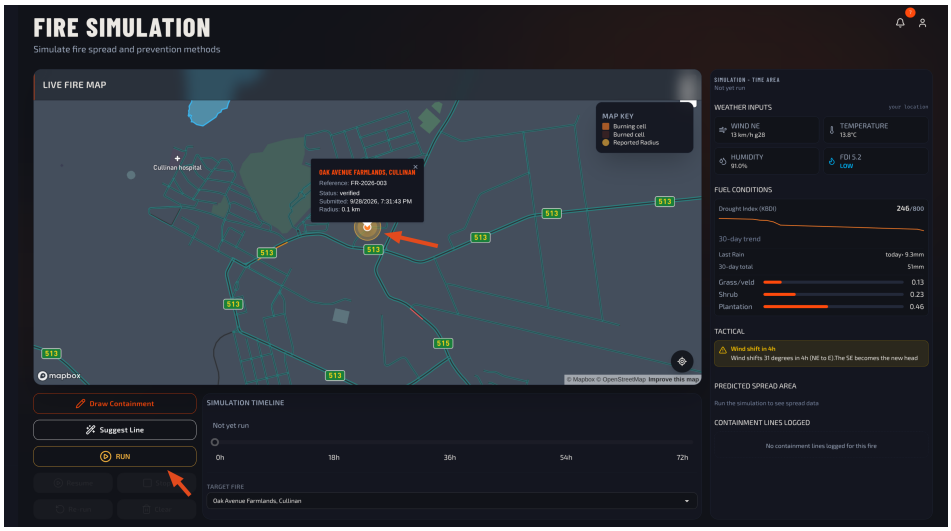


9 Fire Spread Simulation

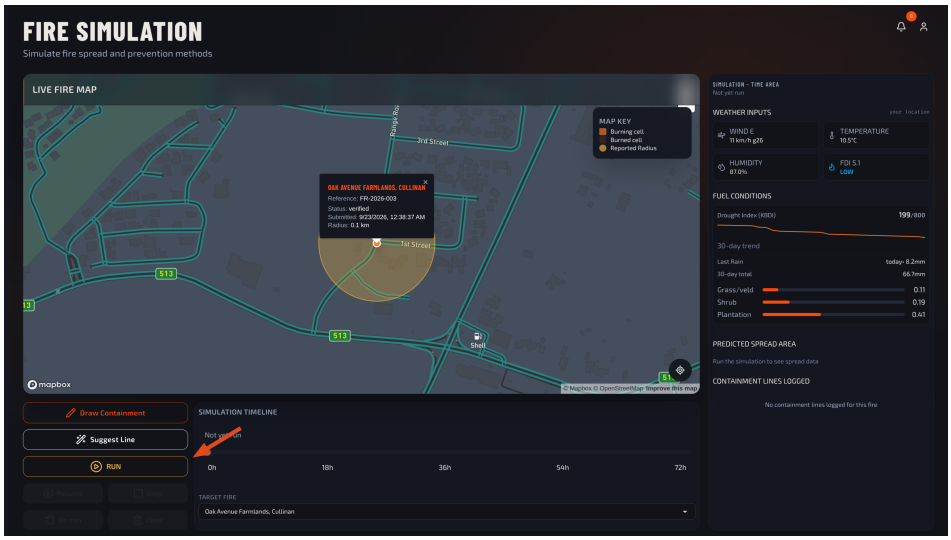
The interactive Fire Spread Simulation page is used by firefighters. The simulation allows for firefighters to visualize how a fire spreads over a certain period of time based on live weather and environmental conditions. Firefighters are also able to draw containment lines on the map to visualize where to place containment systems to stop/slow the spread of fire.

9.1 Running the Interactive Fire Spread Simulation

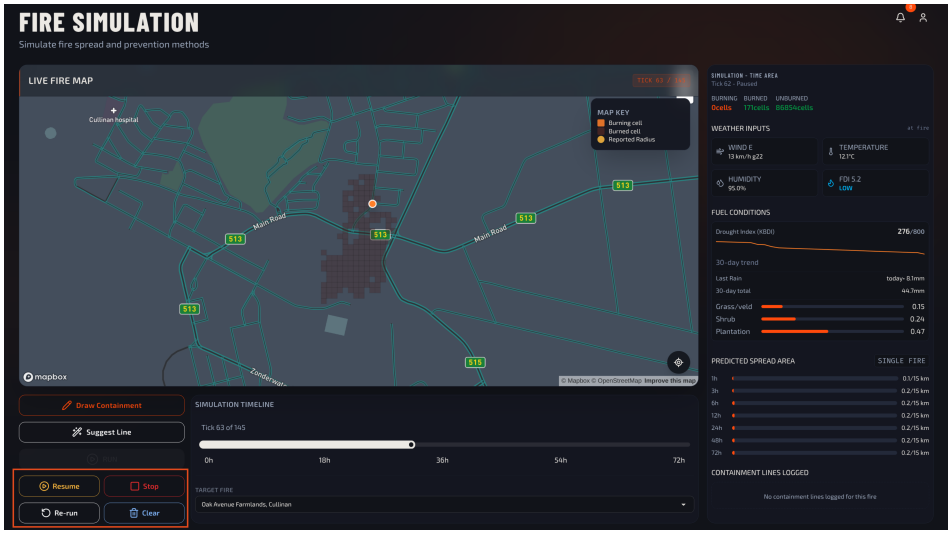
1. Click on a fire



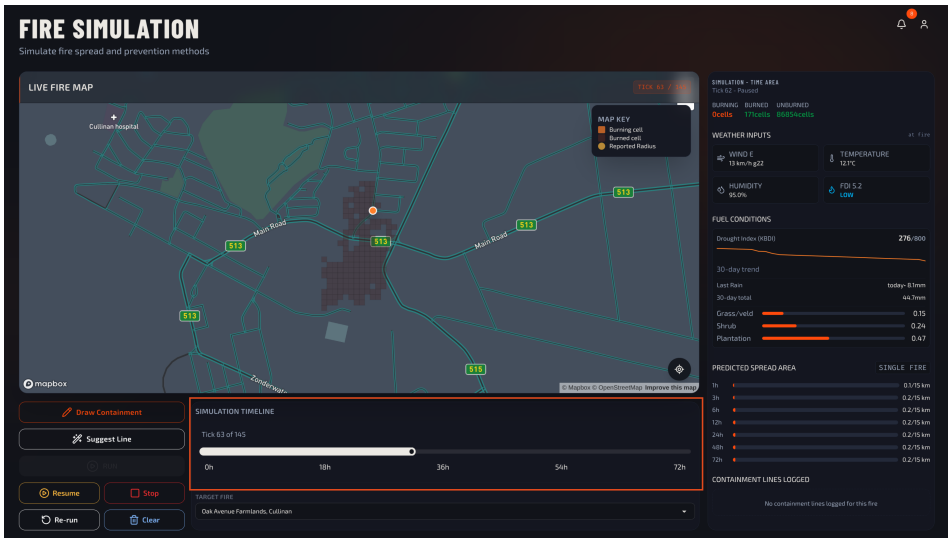
2. Click the ”RUN” button



3. While the simulation is running, you have access to resume, stop, and re-run the simulation

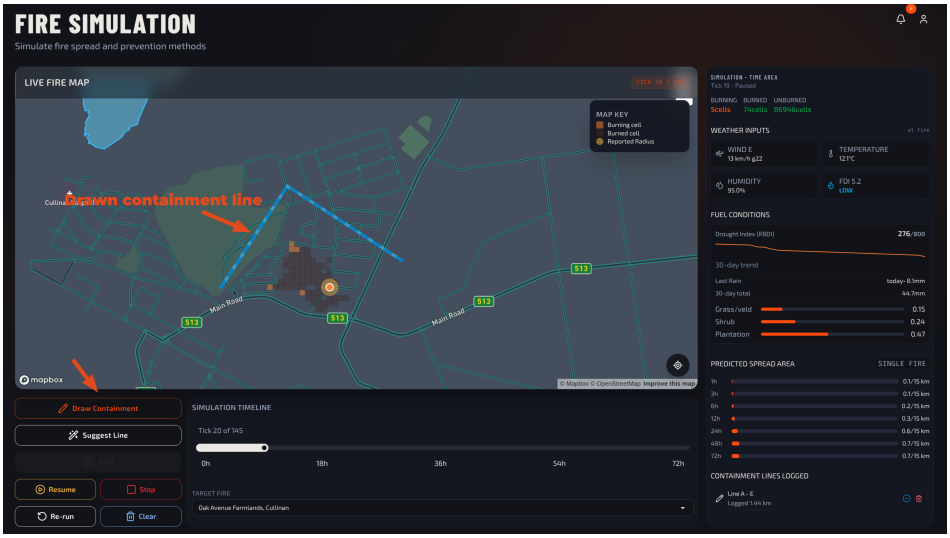


4. The simulation can also be examined tick-by-tick by making use of the **Simulation Timeline** slider under the map



9.2 Drawing/Logging Fire Spread Containment Lines

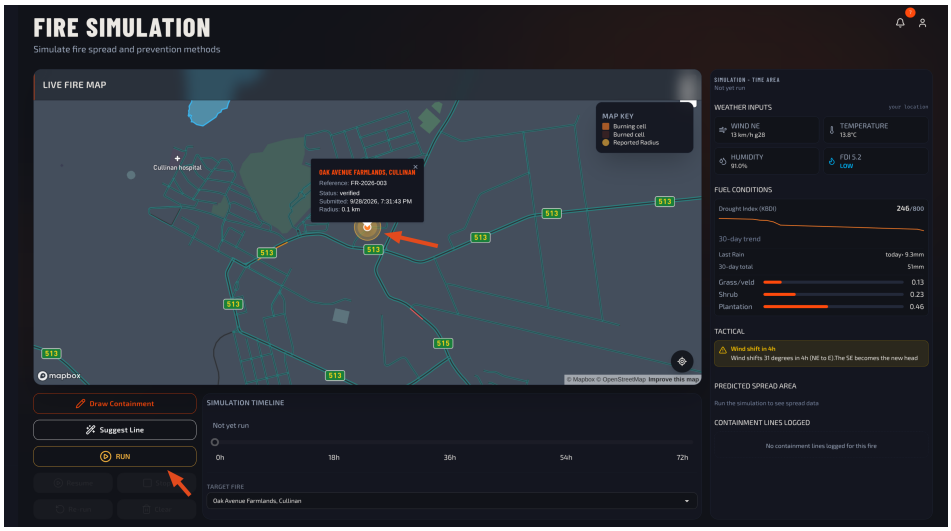
1. Click the 'Draw Containment' button
2. Click your desired location on the map where you want to place a containment line
3. Move your pointer to your desired destination location and double click to place the containment line



9.3 Suggested Containment Lines

In addition to drawing containment lines manually, Fire Away can suggest a containment line for a selected fire, based on its predicted spread. The suggestion takes into account how quickly the fire is expected to reach different areas, so that only lines a crew could realistically complete in time are shown.

1. Select a fire from the **Target Fire** dropdown. A suggestion can only be generated for a single, specific fire.

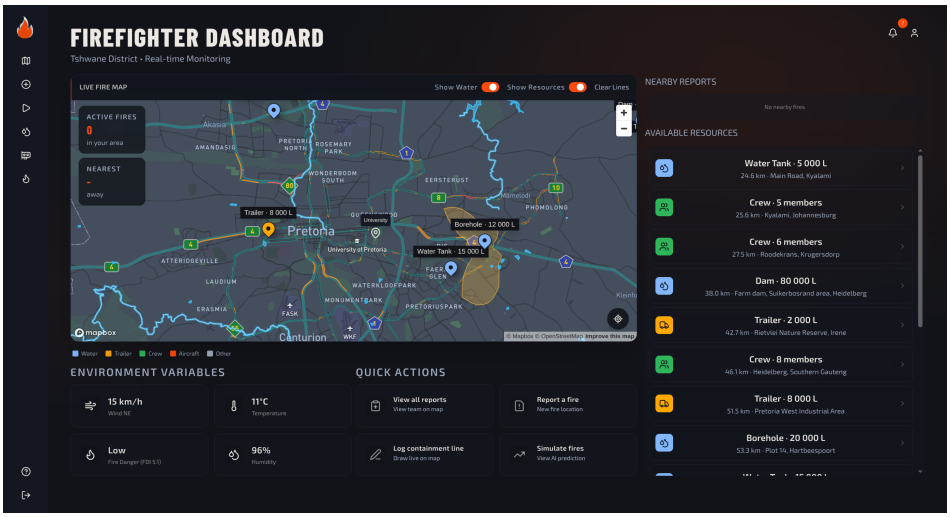


2. Click the **Suggest Line** button.
3. If a feasible line is found, it appears on the map as a dashed purple line, along with a card showing the line's **length**, the estimated **build time**, and the **safety margin**, the amount of extra time a crew would have before the fire is predicted to reach the line.
4. From here, you can either:
   - Click **Accept & Rerun** to log the suggested line as a containment line and automatically re-run the simulation with it included, or
   - Click **Dismiss** to discard the suggestion without logging it.
5. If no line can be safely completed before the fire is predicted to reach the area, for example, if the fire is spreading too quickly, no suggestion is shown, and a short message is displayed instead.

The **Suggest Line** button is disabled when *"All verified fires"* is selected, since a suggestion is generated relative to one fire's predicted spread.

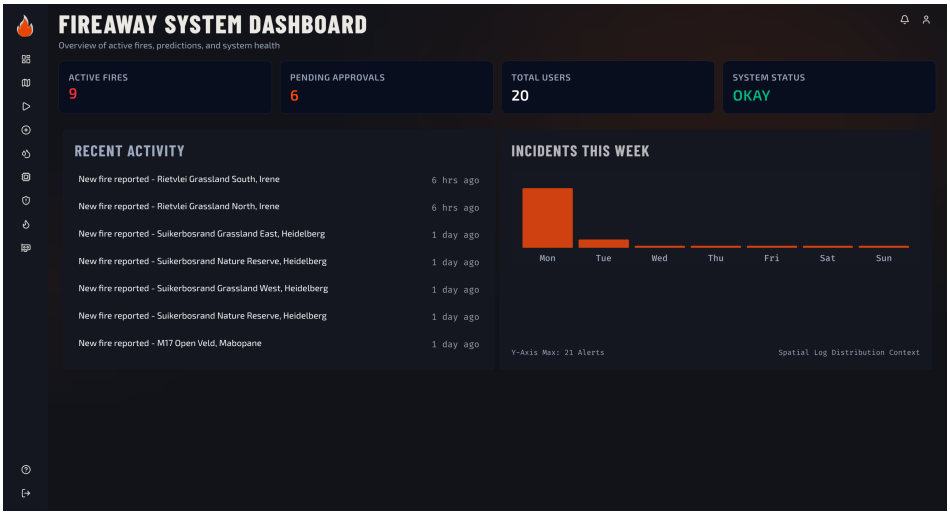
10 Firefighter Tactical Dashboard

The Firefighter Tactical Dashboard is a page specifically designed to equip firefighters with all the relevant information they need to see as soon as they login. This page comprises of a live fire map, current weather and environmental conditions as well as nearby fires.



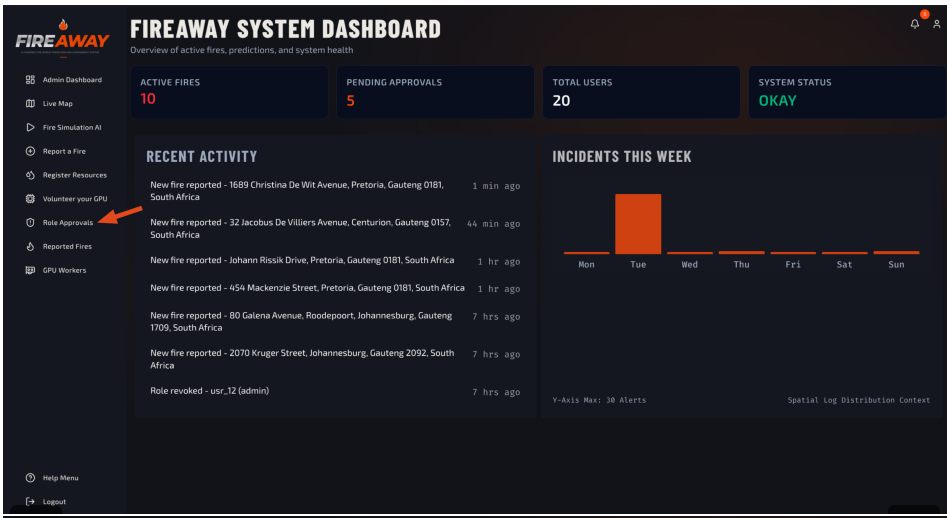
11 Admin Dashboard

The Admin Dashboard is accessible to admins only. Here they can see the total active fires, the amount of pending approvals, the total users of the web app and the system's status. There is a table of recent activity in terms of fires reported, role requests, role revocations and fire approvals and rejections. There is also a bar graph of the weekdays showing the incidents this week in terms of reported and verified fires. Each day is represented by a bar and when hovering over a bar an admin will also be able to see the exact number of incidents of each day. Further the model's metrics are displayed at the bottom. The number of predictions that have been completed, the model's health, the average prediction confidence and if the data sources are synced.



12 Role Approval

As an **Admin**, you are able to "approve" or "revoke" a user's role request.


FIREAWAY
FIREAWAY SYSTEM DASHBOARD
Overview of active fires, predictions, and system health
Admin Dashboard
Live Map
Fire Simulation AI
Report a Fire
Register Resources
Volunteer your GPU
Role Approvals
Reported Fires
GPU Workers
Help Menu
Logout
ACTIVE FIRES
10
PENDING APPROVALS
5
TOTAL USERS
20
SYSTEM STATUS
OKAY
RECENT ACTIVITY
New fire reported - 1689 Christina De Wit Avenue, Pretoria, Gauteng 0181, South Africa
1 min ago
New fire reported - 32 Jacobus De Villiers Avenue, Centurion, Gauteng 0157, South Africa
44 min ago
New fire reported - Johann Rissik Drive, Pretoria, Gauteng 0181, South Africa
1 hr ago
New fire reported - 454 Mackenzie Street, Pretoria, Gauteng 0181, South Africa
1 hr ago
New fire reported - 80 Galena Avenue, Roodepoort, Johannesburg, Gauteng 1709, South Africa
7 hrs ago
New fire reported - 2070 Kruger Street, Johannesburg, Gauteng 2092, South Africa
7 hrs ago
Role revoked - usr_12 (admin)
7 hrs ago
INCIDENTS THIS WEEK
Mon
Tue
Wed
Thu
Fri
Sat
Sun
Y-Axis Max: 30 Alerts
Spatial Log Distribution Context

ROLE APPROVALS
Manage user role requests
Search role requests
ALL
PENDING
APPROVED
REJECTED
REVOKED
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EMAIL
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Rejected
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Deon Steyn
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Rejected
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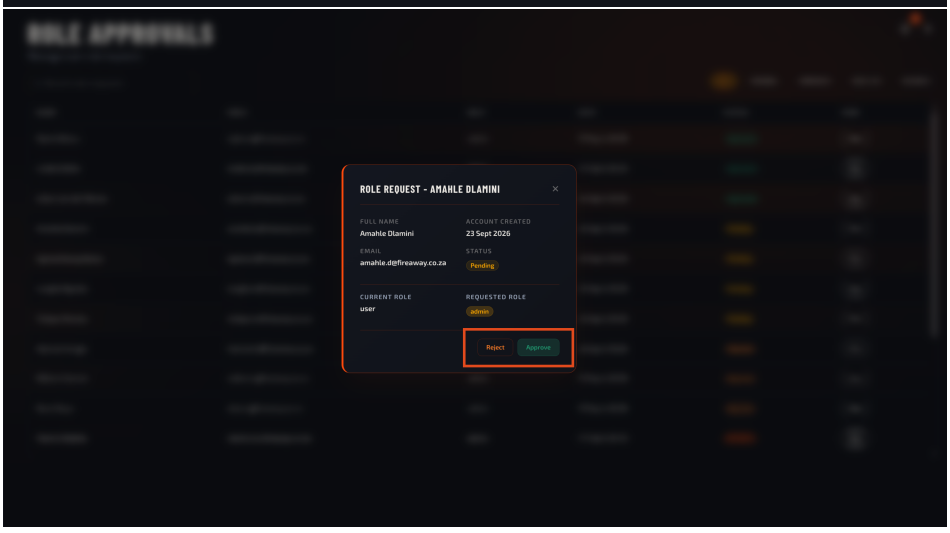
23 Sept | 00:38
Revoked
View


ROLE REQUEST - AMAHLE DLAMINI
FULL NAME
Amahle Dlamini
ACCOUNT CREATED
23 Sept 2026
EMAIL
amahle.d@fireaway.co.za
STATUS
Pending
CURRENT ROLE
user
REQUESTED ROLE
admin
Reject
Approve

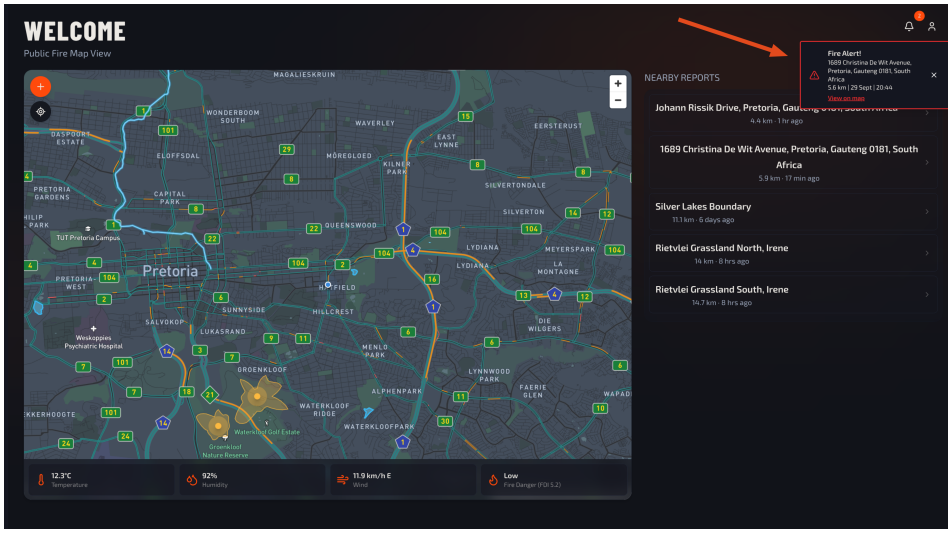
13 Notifications

Fire Away keeps Registered Users informed of fire activity near them without requiring them to keep the app open. Push notifications are only available to Registered Users. Guests do not receive push notifications, since no account or location subscription exists to notify, but still receive in-app notifications.

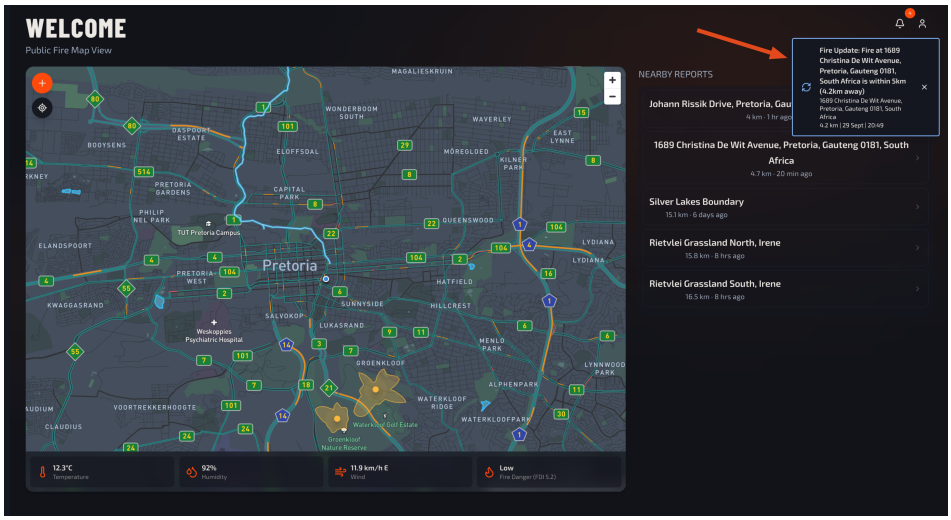
13.1 Proximity-Based Alerts

When a fire report is verified (either automatically or manually by an Admin or Firefighter), FireAway checks which Registered Users are located near the fire and sends each of them a push notification. This ensures that residents in the affected area are made aware of a nearby fire as soon as it is confirmed, rather than having to actively check the Live Fire Map.

1. A fire report is submitted and moves through the verification process.
2. Once the report's status changes to Verified, it identifies users within the notification radius of the fire's location.



3. Users are also notified of fire updates (i.e. fire boundary drawing nearer in the threshold boundary)

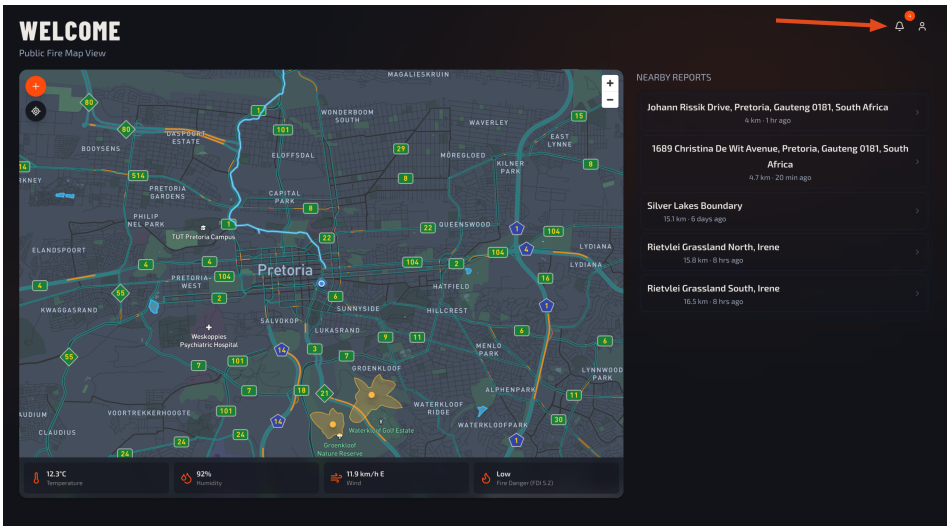


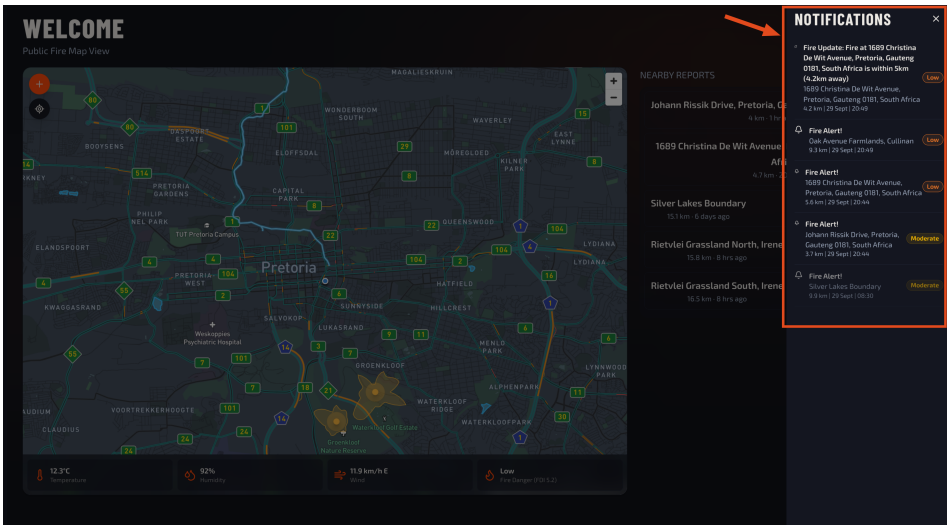
4. A push notification is sent to each affected user's device, alerting them to new fires nearby / fire updates.

5. Tapping the notification takes the user directly to the Live Fire Map, centered on the reported fire.

13.2 Viewing Notifications

In addition to push notifications, Registered Users can review the past 24 hours of notifications from within the app at any time by clicking the bell icon. This is useful for checking on fires that may have been reported while the user was offline, or to revisit an earlier alert.





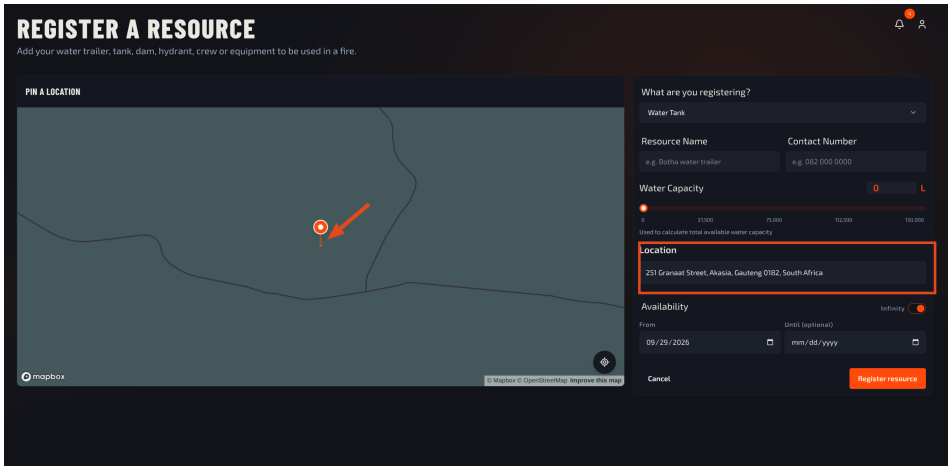
14 Registering a Resource

Fire Away allows members of the community to register resources that could help fight a fire, such as a water tank, a borehole, a water trailer, a dam, an aircraft or a crew of volunteers. Once registered, the resource appears on the Live Map, where firefighters can see which resources are close to an active fire.

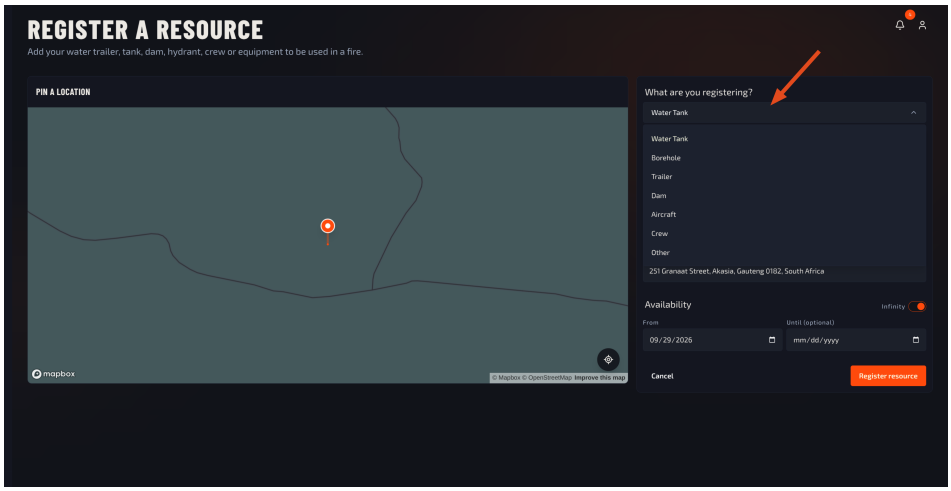
The Register a Resource page is available to Registered Users, Firefighters and Admins.

14.1 Registering a resource

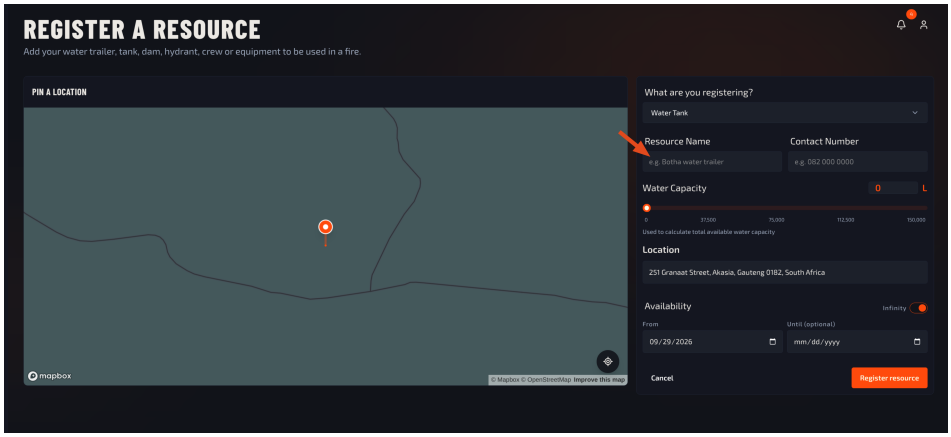
1. Click a location on the map or search for the location in the search bar to place the resource pin.



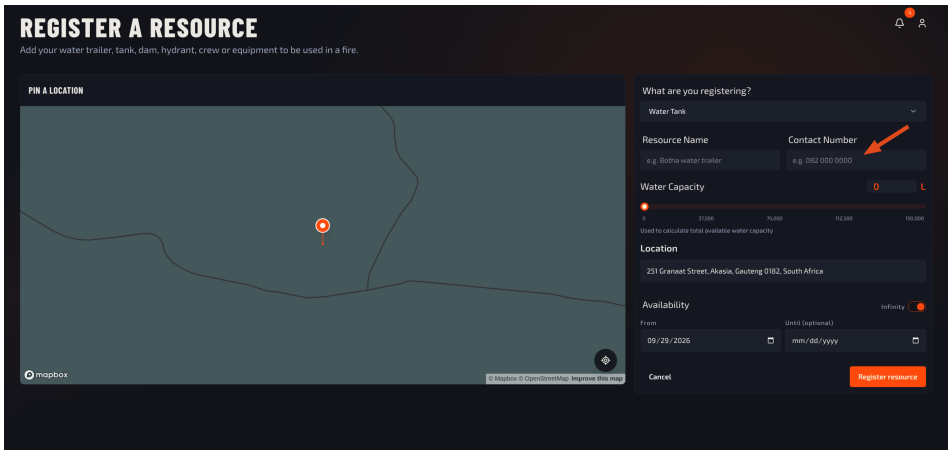
2. Select the type of resource from the dropdown. If none of the options fit, select 'Other' and describe the resource in the text box that appears.



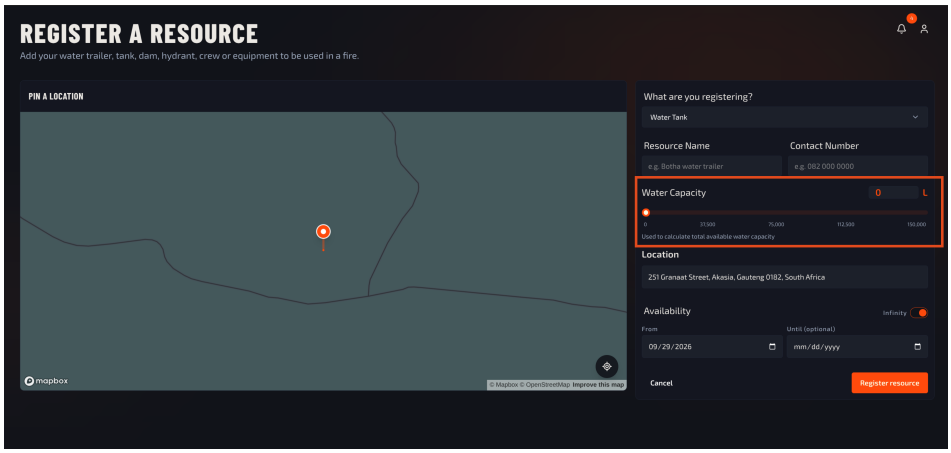
3. Enter a name for the resource, for example ‘Pieter’s water trailer’.



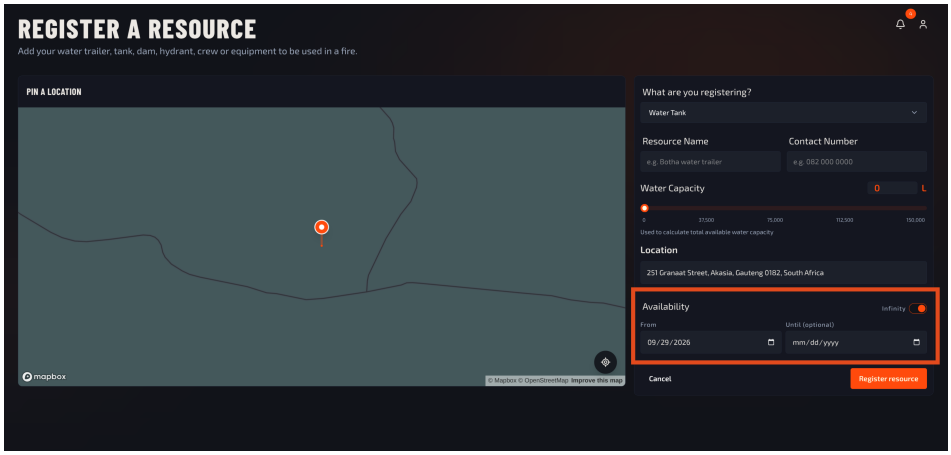
4. Enter a contact phone number so that firefighters can reach you if the resource is needed.



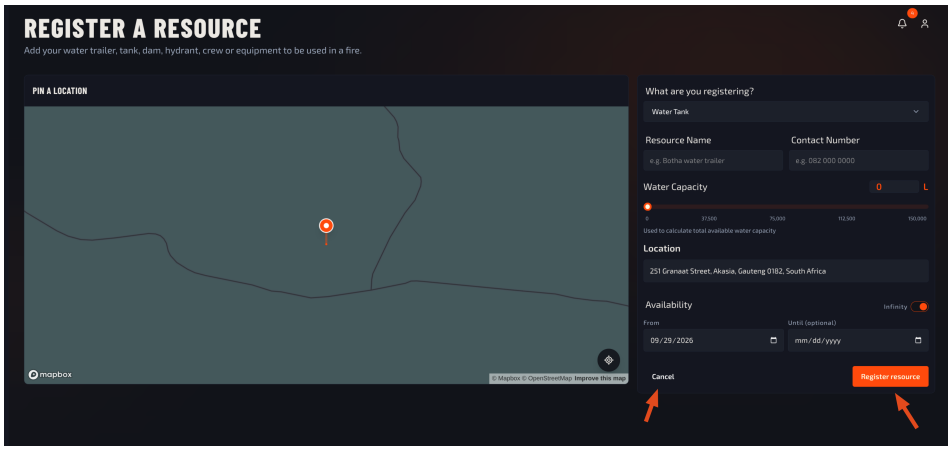
5. Set the capacity of the resource by typing a value or by moving the slider.



6. Click the 'Choose availability' button and select the dates during which the resource is available. If no end date is chosen, the resource stays available until it is set as dispatched or unavailable by the user.



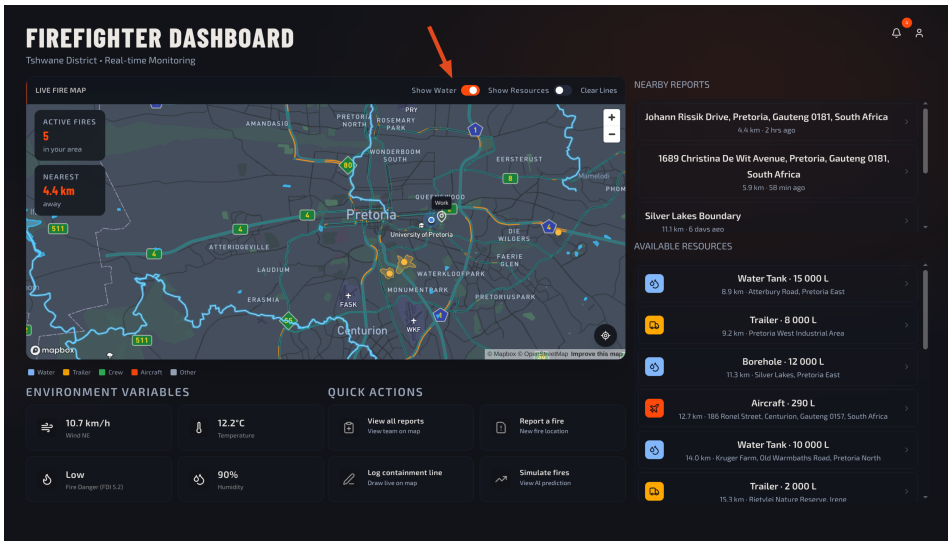
7. Click the 'Register Resource' button to submit, or 'Cancel' to discard the form.



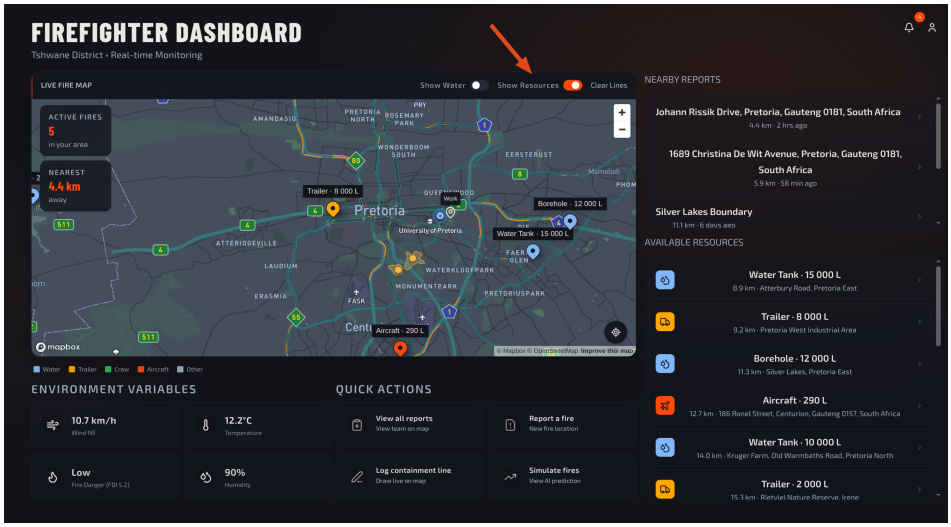
15 Nearby Water Resources for Firefighters

This feature allows firefighters to see where the nearest resources are that could potentially aid them in extinguishing a fire.

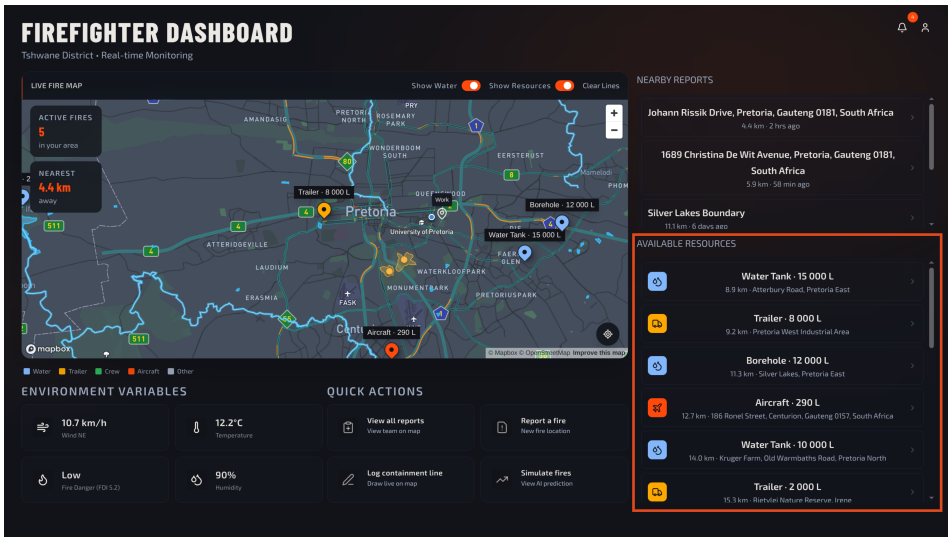
1. **Open Water Source Overlay**
   Firefighters are able to toggle the water overlay on and off using the "Show Water" toggle on the top right side of the map. This highlights all sufficient open water sources near the firefighter that they can use.



2. **Resources Overlay**
   The resource overlay can be toggled on and off similar to the water overlay. This overlay displays, on the map, all the resources that have been registered by users.



3. **Available Resources List**
   The available resources list is found next to the live fire map, under the nearby fires list. This list displays the resources near a firefighter from the closest to furtherest resources.



16 Registering a GPU

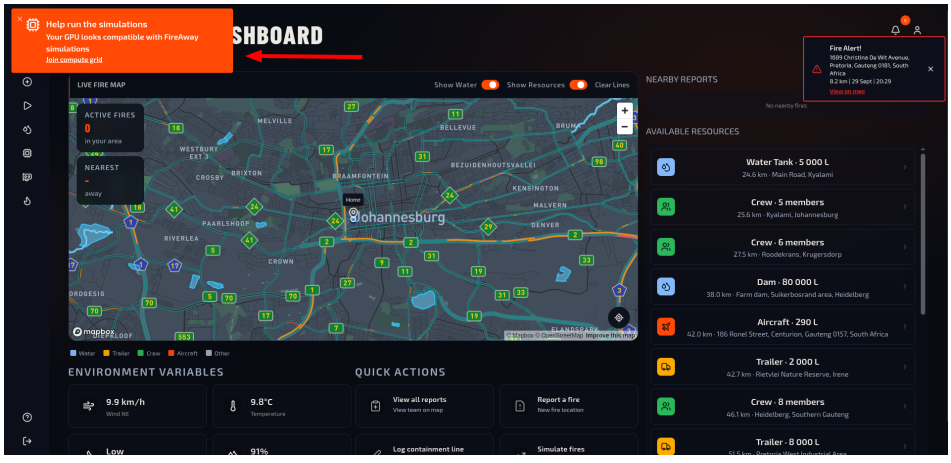
The AI fire spread simulation needs a lot of computing power. Fire Away lets users lend an idle NVIDIA GPU with CUDA core compatibility to the 'compute grid', a pool of volunteer machines that run simulation jobs. Each volunteer machine runs a GPU worker, a program that connects to Fire Away, receives simulation jobs and sends the results back.

Volunteering a GPU is available to Registered Users, Firefighters and Admins who have a GPU that is powerful enough for use. Admins and Firefighters can manage the machines on the GPU Workers page.

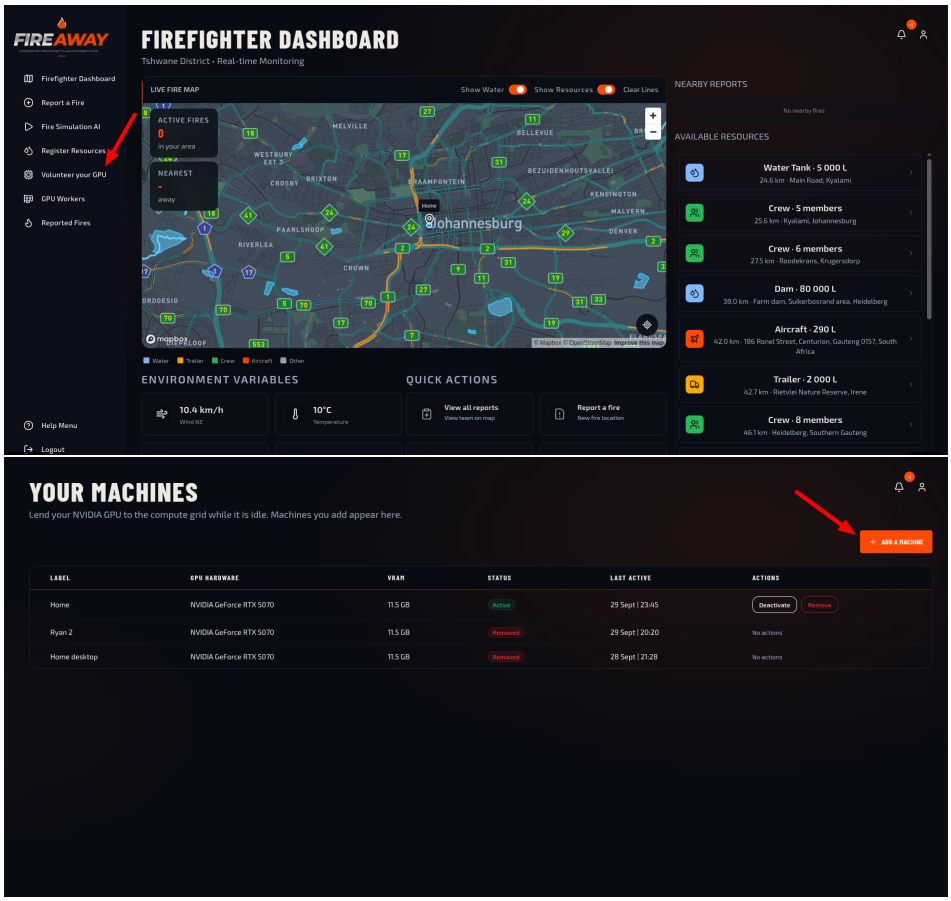
16.1 Adding a machine

Fire Away requires Docker to be installed on the machine that will lend its GPU. If your GPU is eligible (minimum 4GB VRAM & CUDA cores support) to volunteer:

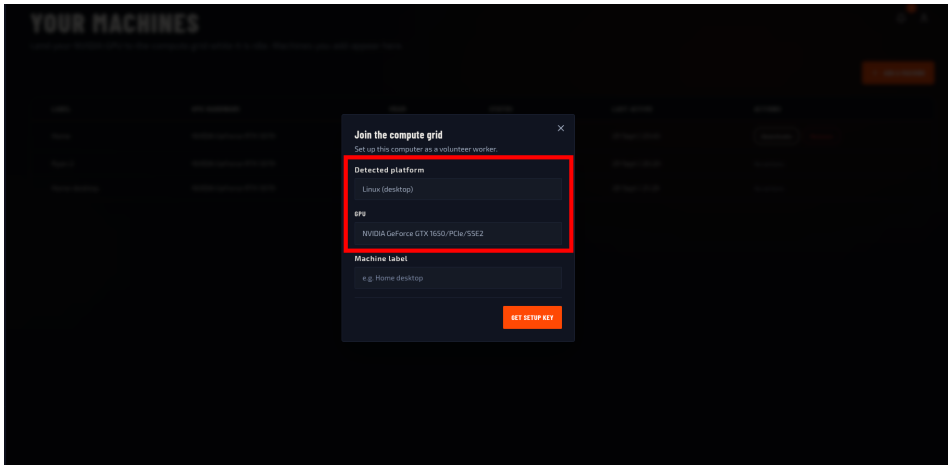
1. A notification will appear, stating it has detected an eligible GPU.



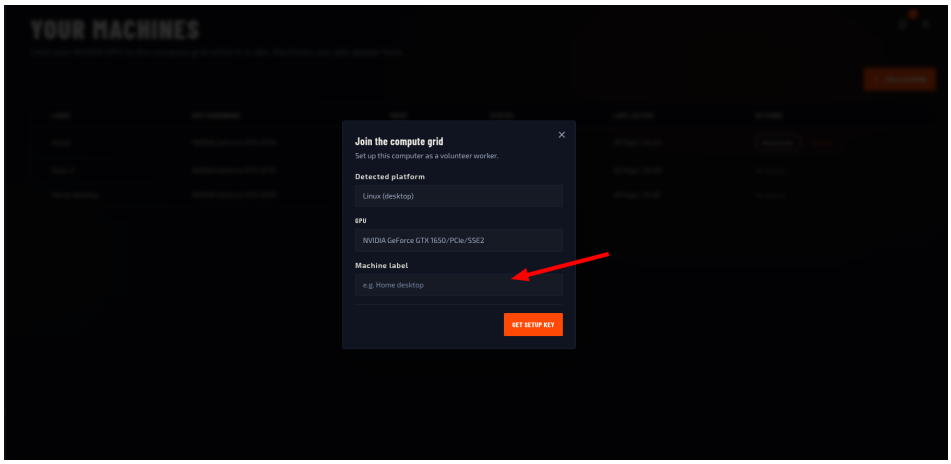
2. Open the Your Volunteer Your GPU page and click the 'Add a Machine' button.



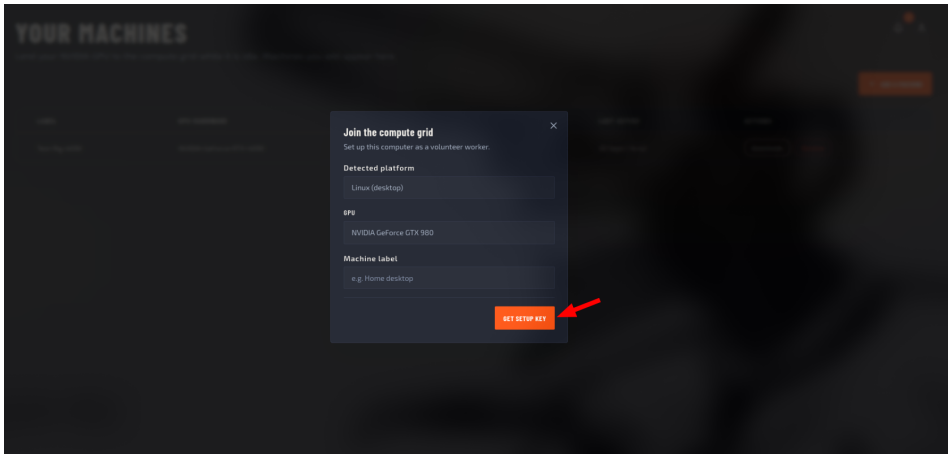
3. In the pop-up, you can see your GPU specs. These fields are filled in automatically by our system.



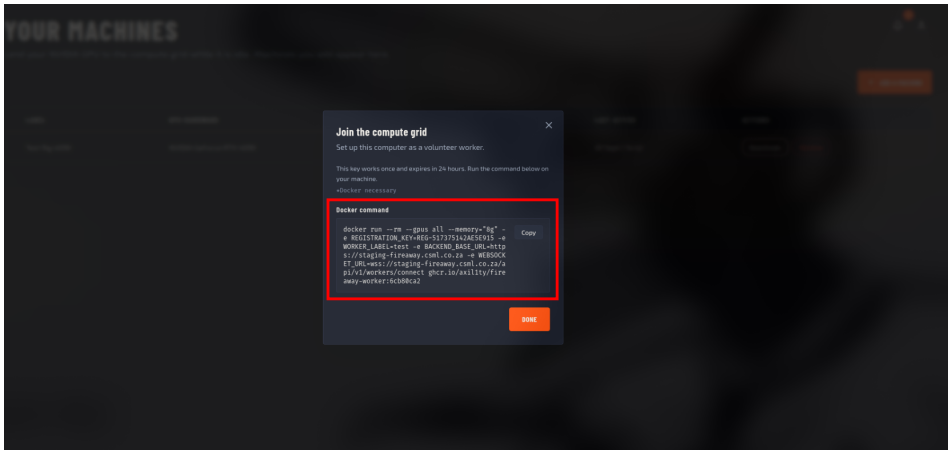
4. Enter a name for the machine in the 'Machine label' field, for example 'Home desktop'.



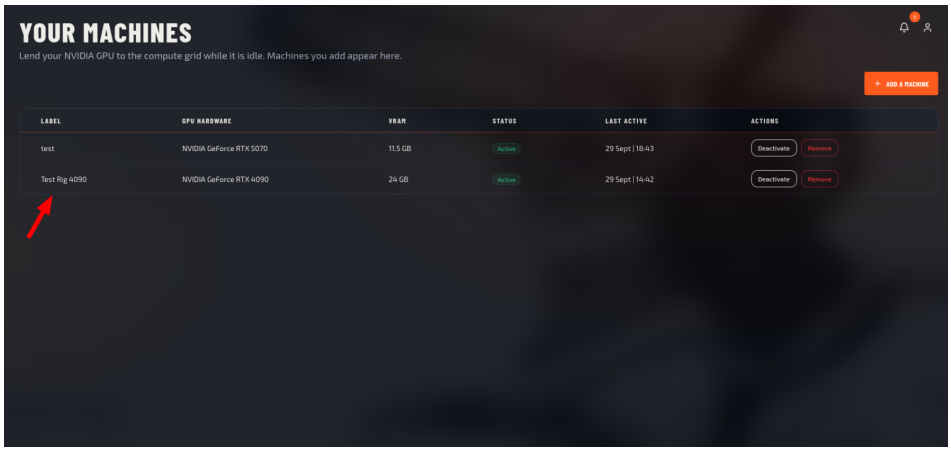
5. Click the 'Get Setup Key' button.



6. A Docker command containing your one-time setup key is displayed. Click the 'Copy' button and run the command in a terminal on your machine.



7. Click 'Done'. Once the worker starts and connects, the machine appears in the table on the Volunteer Your GPU page.

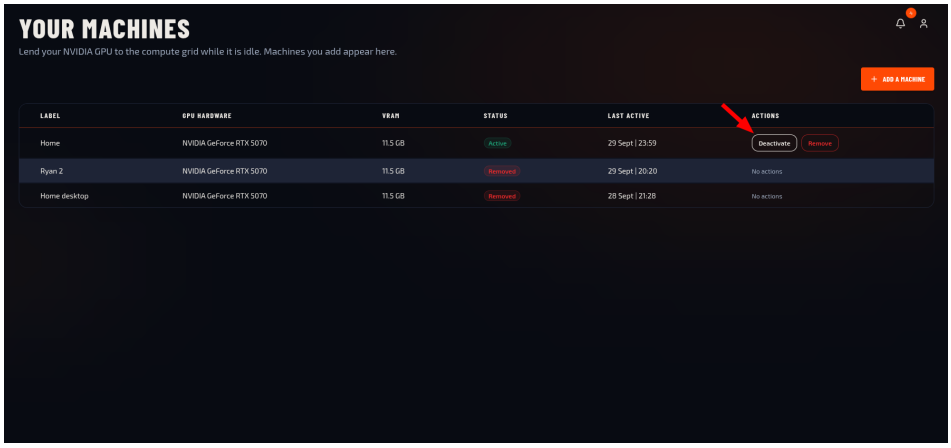


The setup key can only be used once. Do not share your setup key or Docker command with anyone else.

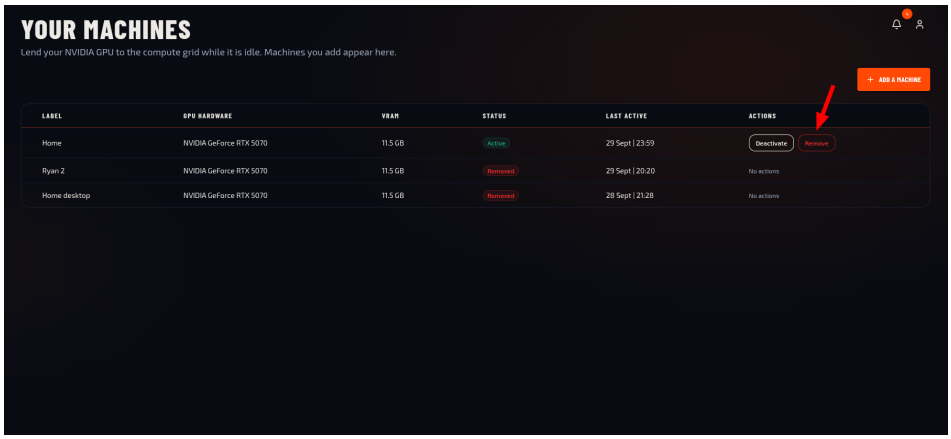
16.2 Deactivating or removing a machine

The Actions column lets you stop lending a machine:

- 'Deactivate' stops the machine from receiving simulation jobs. This action is only shown for machines that are Active.



- 'Remove' removes the machine from the compute grid. It is available for every machine regardless of its status.



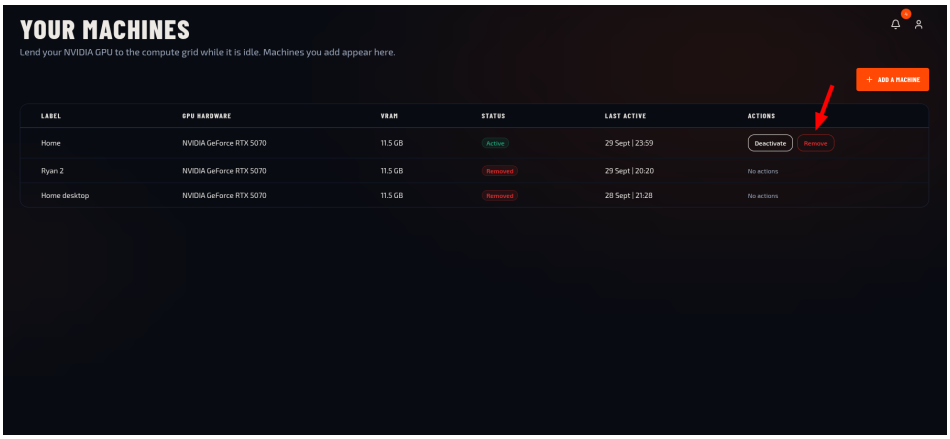
16.3 Machine statuses

- *Active:* the worker is connected and ready to receive simulation jobs.
- *Busy:* the worker is currently running a simulation job.
- *Offline:* the worker is not connected. Start the Docker command again to reconnect the machine.
- *Quarantined:* the machine has been set aside by the system and does not receive jobs.
- *Deactivated:* the machine was deactivated and does not receive jobs.
- *Rejected:* the machine was not accepted onto the compute grid.
- *Removed:* the machine has been removed from the compute grid.

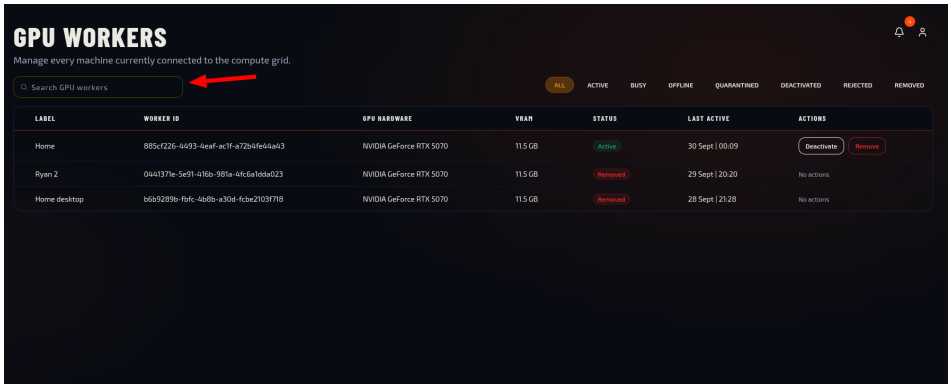
16.4 GPU Workers (Admin/Firefighter)

The GPU Workers page gives Admins and Firefighters an overview of every machine connected to the compute grid, not only their own. In addition to the columns shown on the GPU Workers page, the table shows each machine's information.
For each machine the table shows:

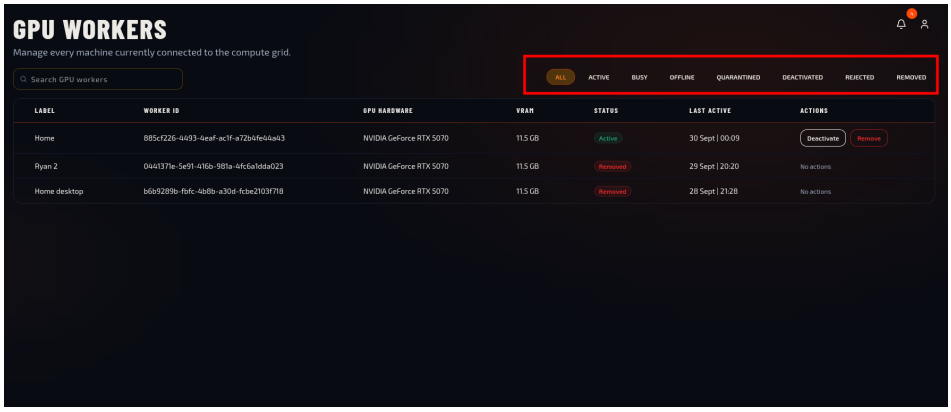
- *Label:* the name you gave the machine.
- *GPU Hardware:* the graphics card detected on the machine.
- *VRAM:* the amount of video memory the GPU has.
- *Status:* the current state of the machine (see Section **??**).
- *Last Active:* the last date and time the machine was seen by the system.
- *Actions:* the actions available for that machine.



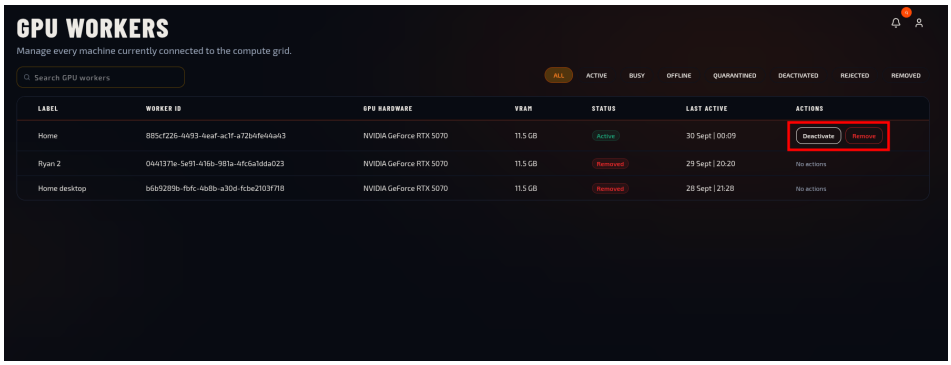
- Use the search bar to find a worker by its label, worker ID, hardware or user.



- Click the labels above the table (All, Active, Busy, Offline, Quarantined, Deactivated, Rejected, Removed) to filter the workers by status.

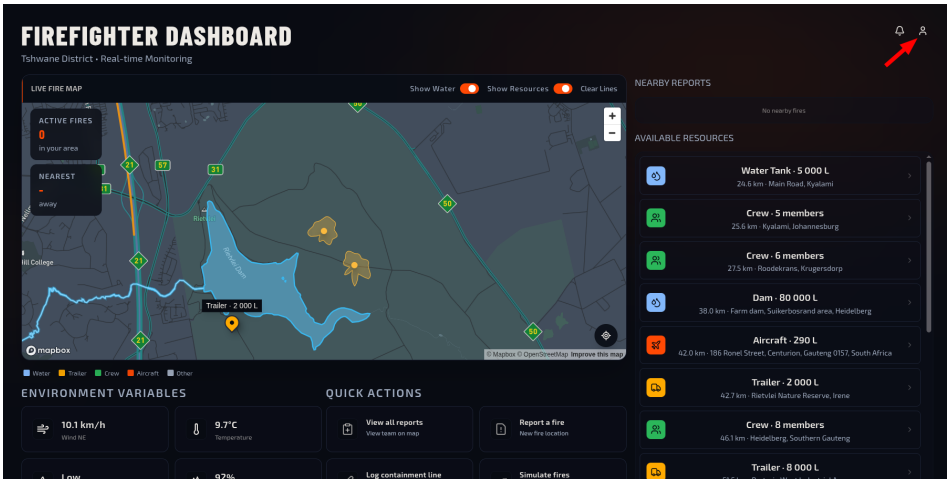


- Use the 'Deactivate' and 'Remove' buttons in the Actions column to stop a worker from receiving jobs or to remove it from the grid.



17 Profile Page

The Profile page shows your account details and gives you a place to manage your role requests, saved locations, fire reports and registered resources. It is available to all Registered Users, Firefighters and Admins and is opened from the profile icon in the top right corner of the screen.

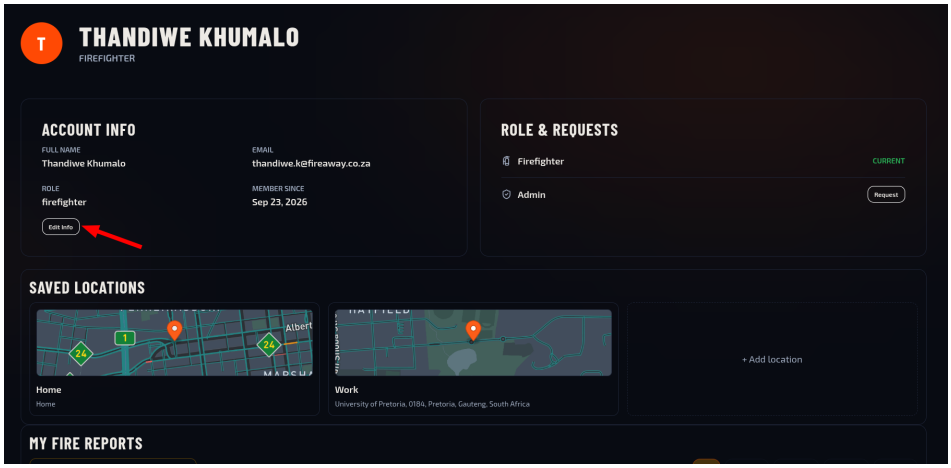


17.1 Account Info

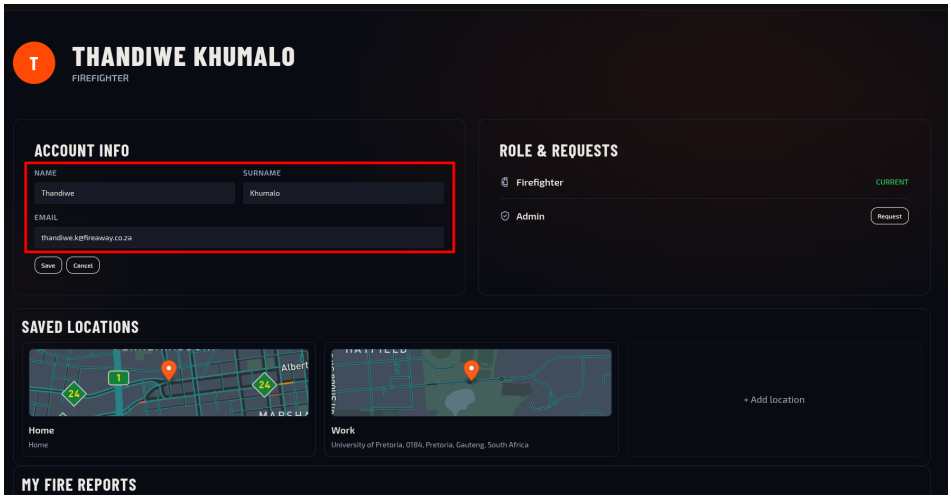
The Account Info card displays your full name, email address, role and the date you became a member.

17.1.1 Editing your account info

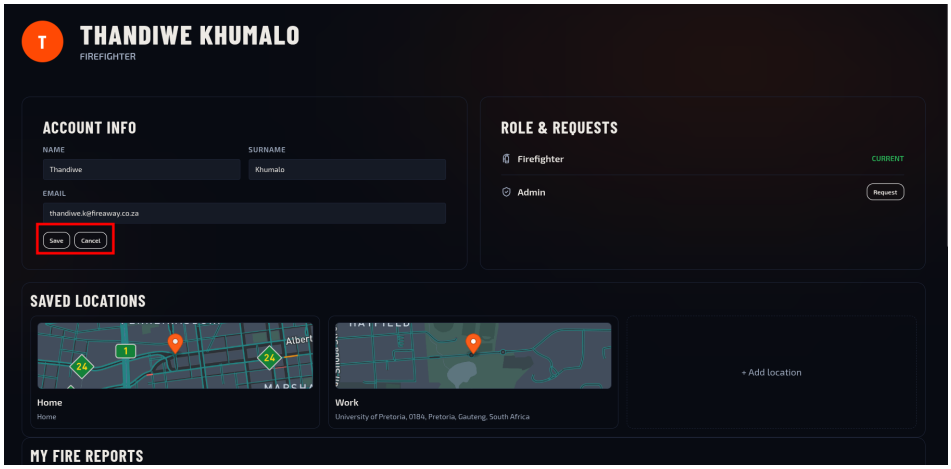
1. Click the 'Edit Info' button on the Account Info card.



2. Change your name, surname or email address in the fields provided.

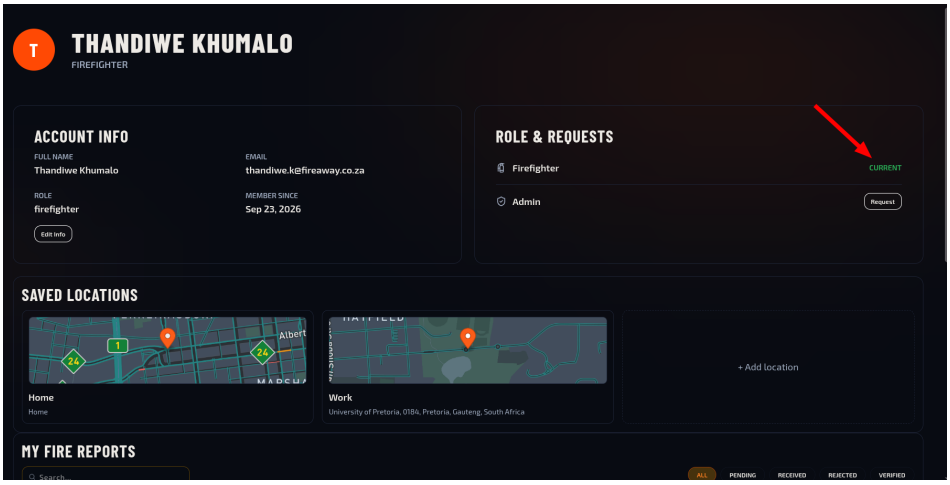


3. Click 'Save' to keep your changes, or 'Cancel' to discard them.



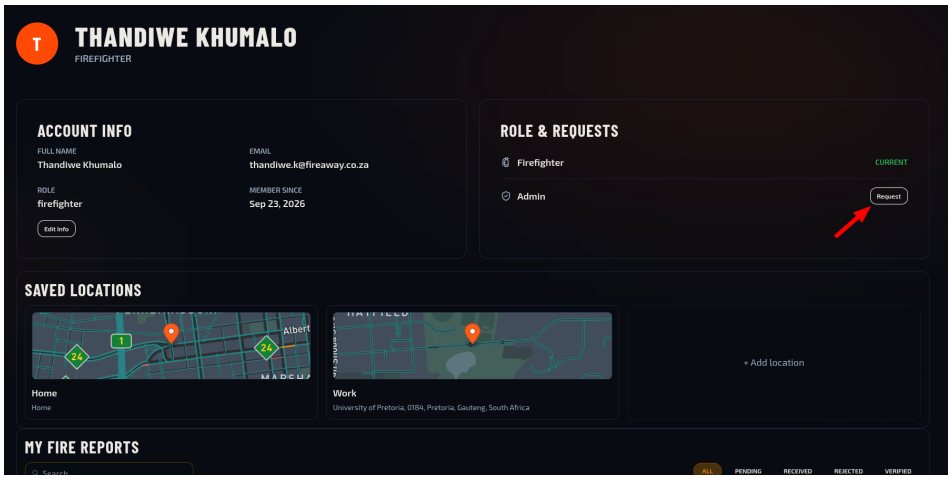
17.2 Role & Requests

The Role & Requests card lists the roles available in Fire Away. Your current role is marked as "Current".

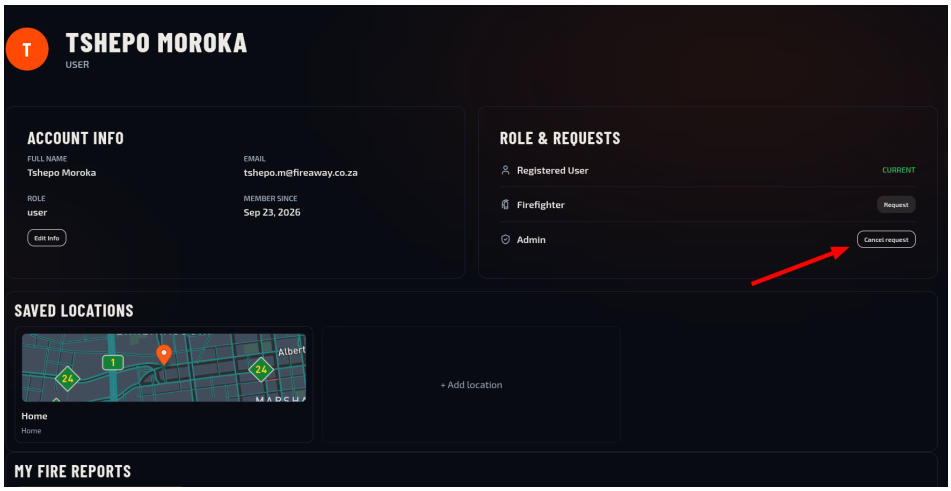


For the other roles:

- Click 'Request' to ask for that role, for example Firefighter or Admin. The request is sent to an Admin, who approves or rejects it on the Role Approval page.



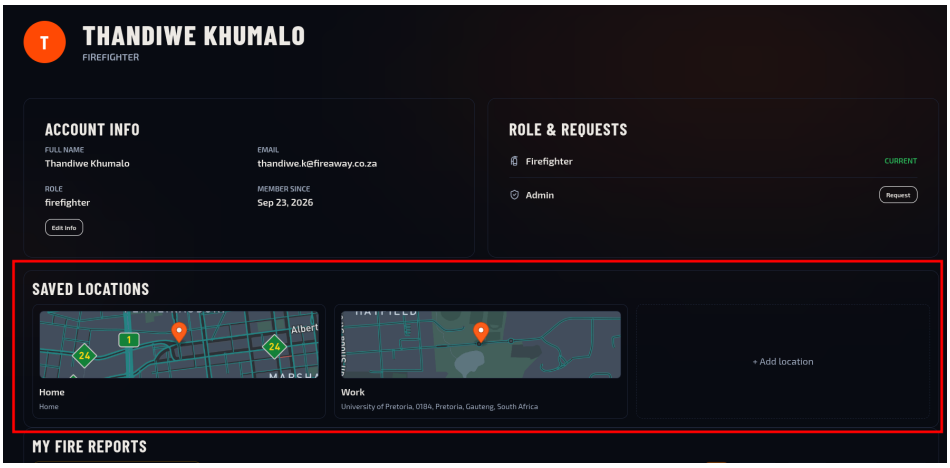
- If you have already requested a role and are waiting for a decision, the button changes to 'Cancel request'. Click it to withdraw the request.



Once a request is approved, your role and the pages available to you are updated.

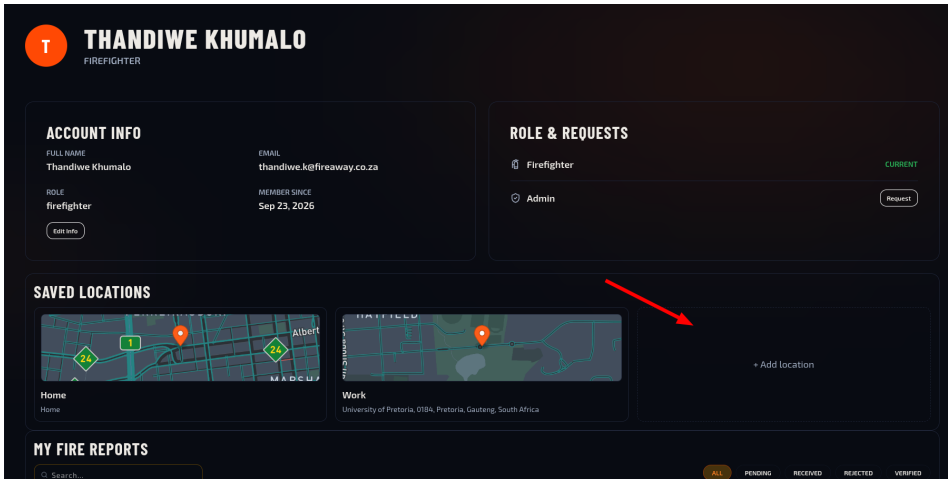
17.3 Saved Locations

Saved Locations lets you keep the places that matter to you, such as your home or your workplace. Each saved location is shown as a card with a small map preview image, its label and its address.

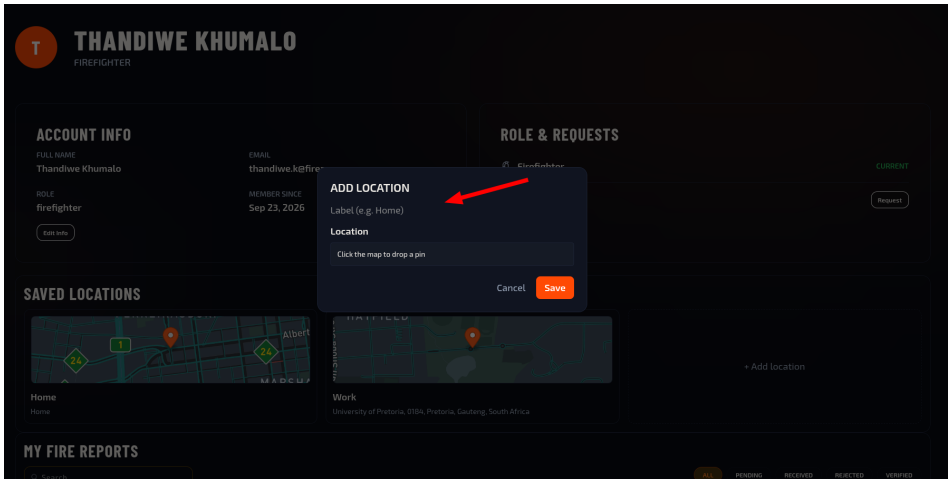


17.3.1 Adding a location

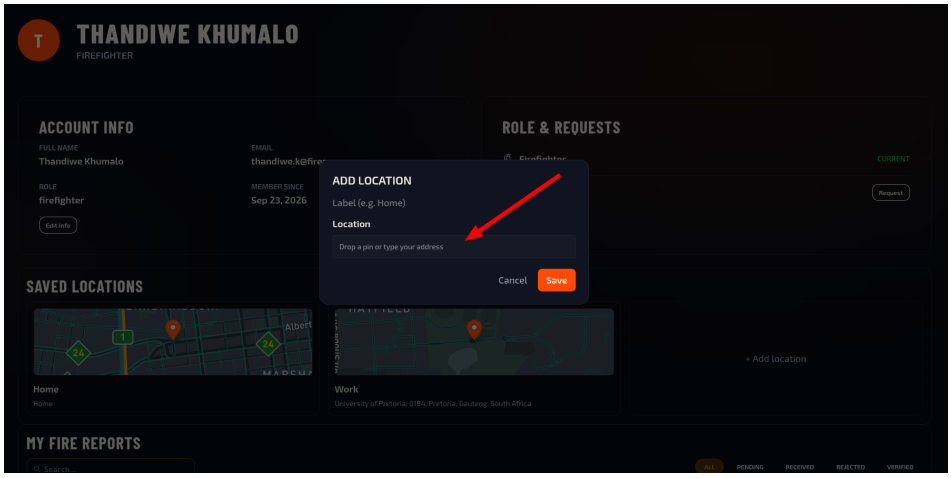
1. Click the 'Add location' card.



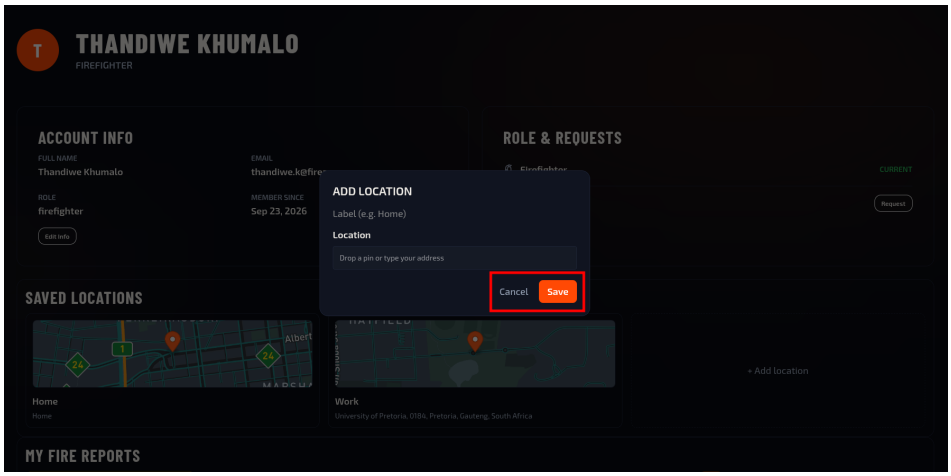
2. In the 'Add Location' pop-up, enter a label for the location, for example "Home".



3. Click on the map to drop a pin at the location.

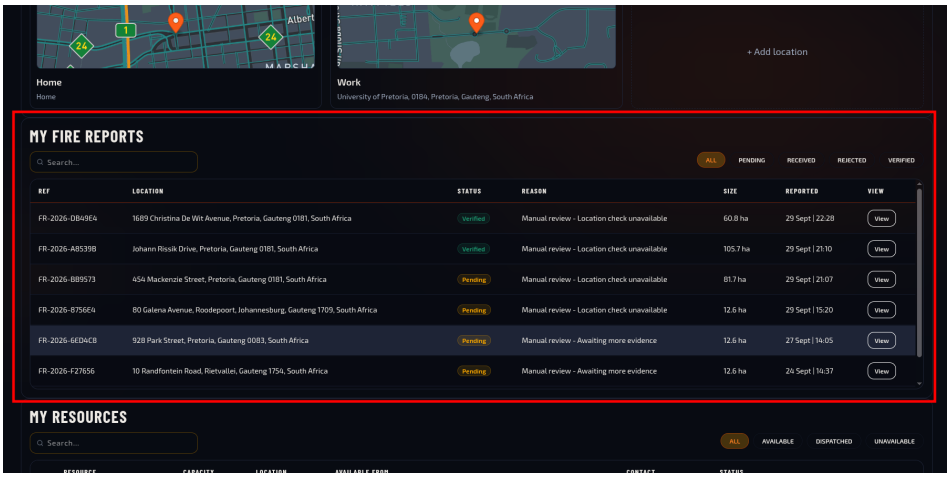


4. Click 'Save' to add the location, or 'Cancel' to close the pop-up without saving.

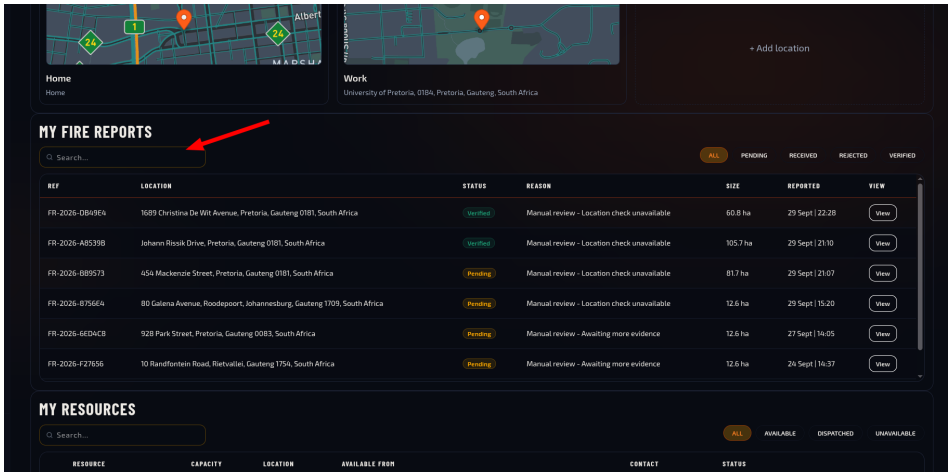


17.4 My Fire Reports

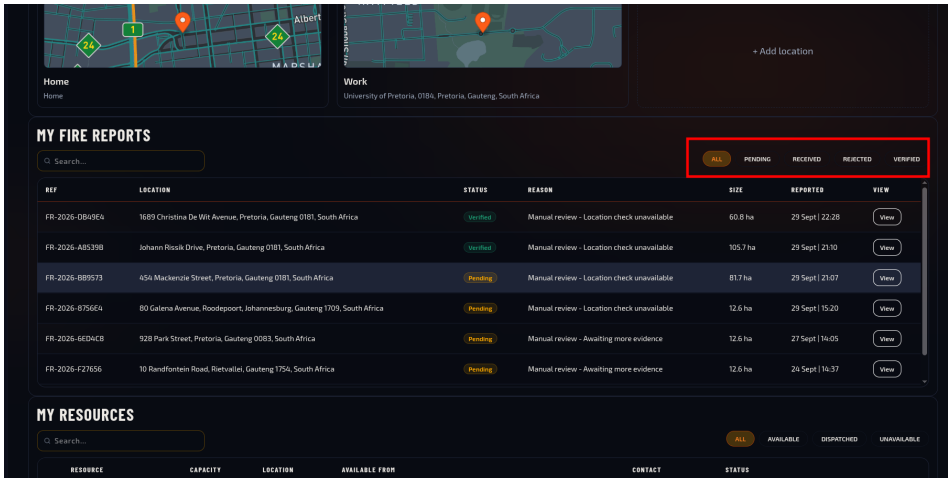
The My Fire Reports table lists every fire report you have submitted.



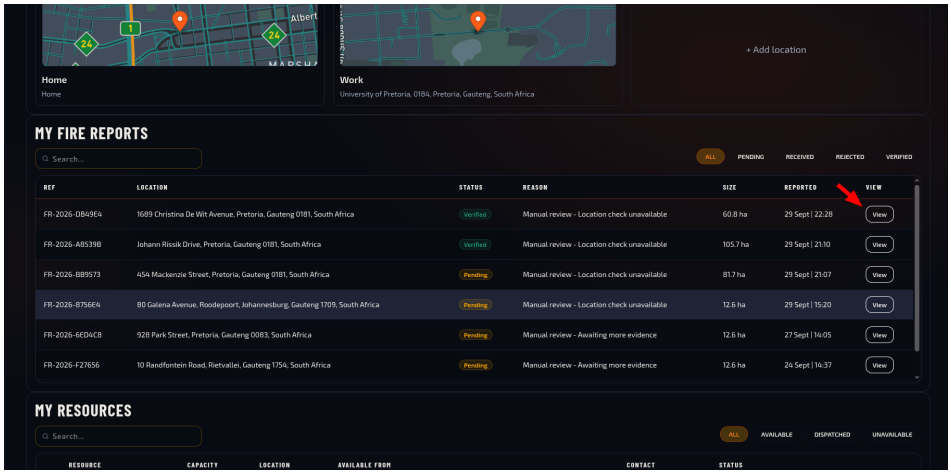
- Use the search bar to find a report.



- Click the labels above the table (All, Pending, Received, Rejected, Verified) to filter the reports by status.

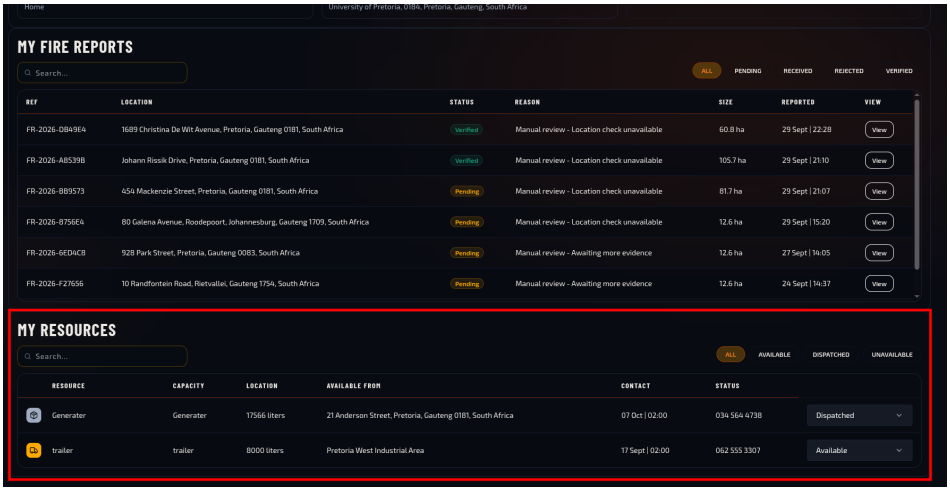


- Click the 'View' button on a report to see more details about it.

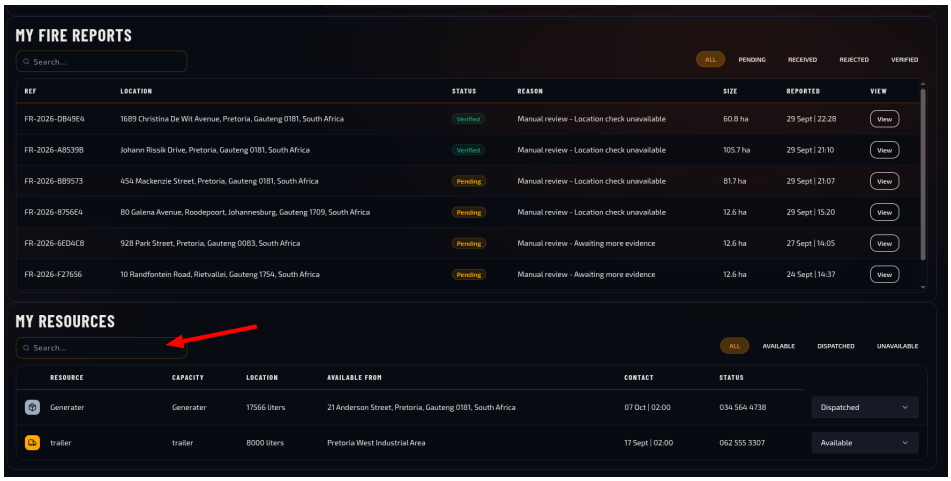


17.5 My Resources

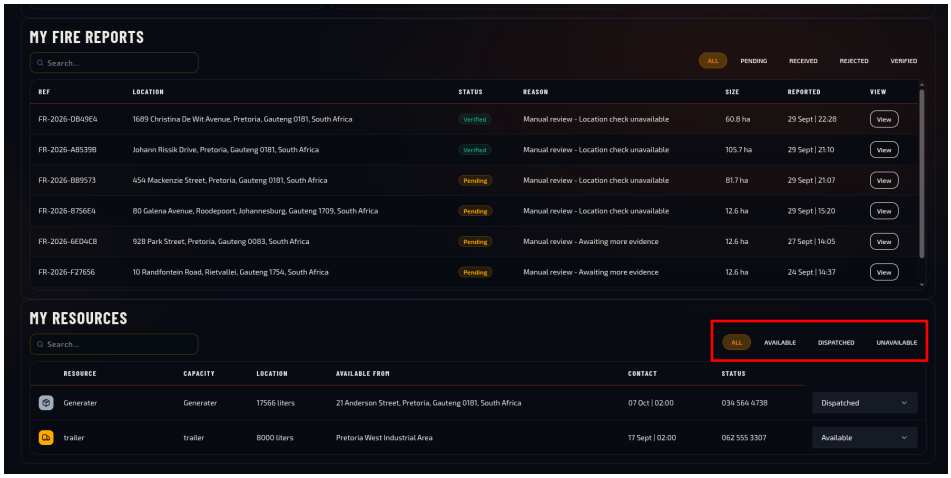
The My Resources table lists every resource you have registered.



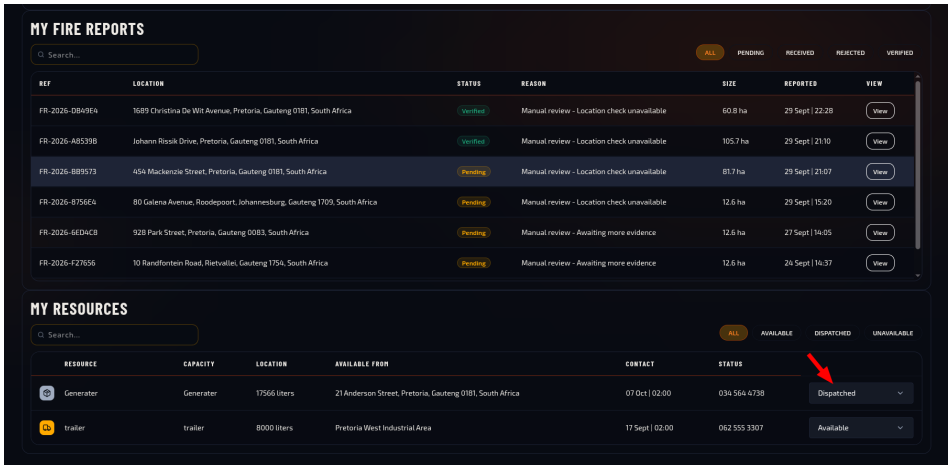
- Use the search bar to find a resource.



- Click the labels above the table (All, Available, Dispatched, Unavailable) to filter the resources by status.



- Use the status dropdown at the end of a row to change the status of a resource. For example, set it to Unavailable if you can no longer lend it out.



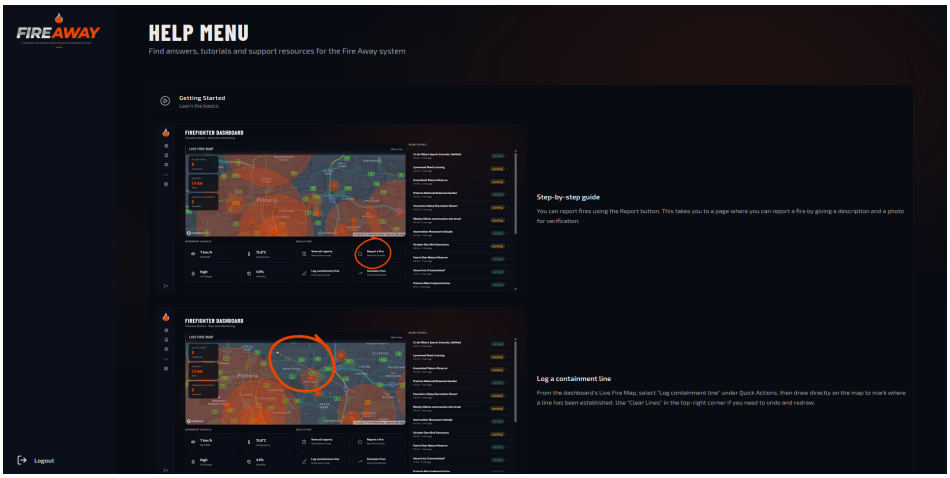
18 Help and Support

The Help Menu can be reached from the sidebar at any time and provides tutorials, frequently asked questions, and emergency contact details.

18.1 Getting Started Tutorials

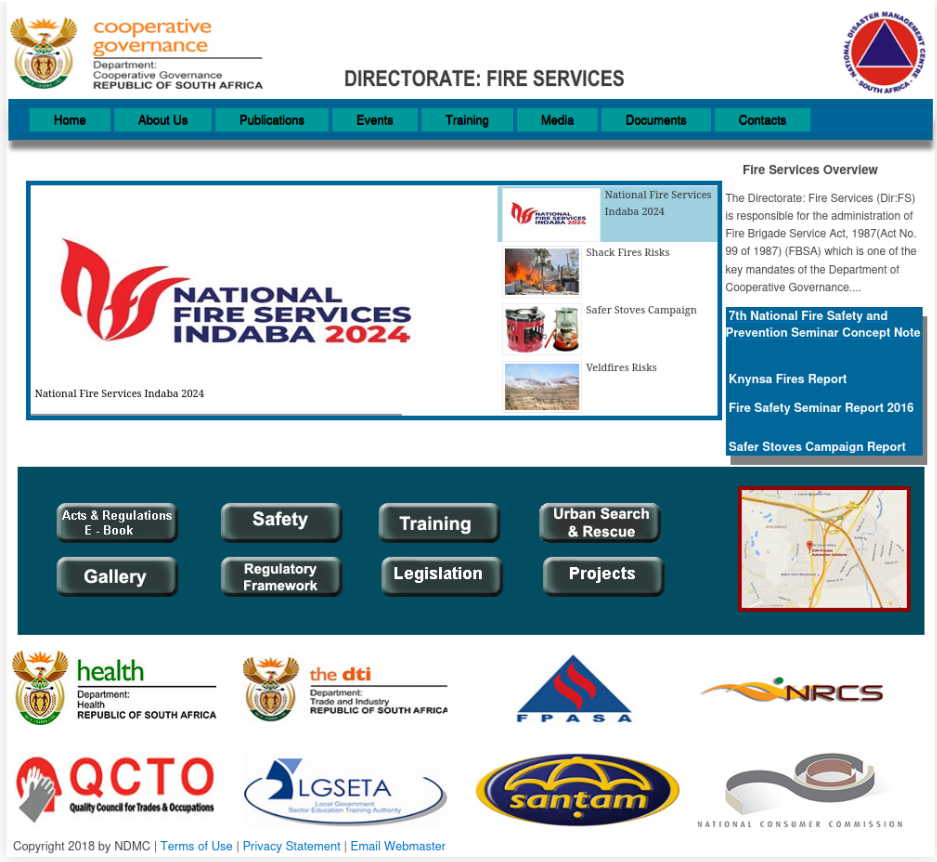
The **Getting Started** panel is an expandable walkthrough with accompanying screenshots covering the app's core workflows step by step:

- Reporting a fire using the Report button, including a description and photo for verification.
- Logging a containment line from the Live Fire Map's Quick Actions menu, by drawing directly on the map (with an option to clear and redraw).
- Simulating a containment strategy from the Fire Simulation view, by sketching a proposed containment line onto the predicted spread map.
- Running the simulation to see how a drawn containment line affects the predicted spread area, using the current weather inputs.
- Stepping through the simulation timeline using the slider to view predicted spread from now out to 24 hours ahead.



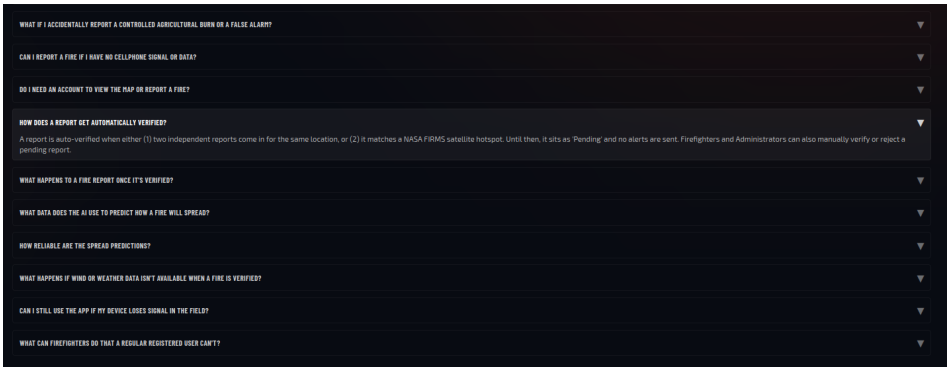
18.2 Help Center

For support beyond the app itself, the Help Center links out to the official South African Fire and Emergency Services website, where users can find professional support resources.



18.3 Frequently Asked Questions

Below the tutorials, an expandable FAQ list answers common questions about the platform, including: what information is needed to report a fire; how to correct or cancel a mistaken report; account requirements for viewing the map versus reporting a fire; how reports are automatically verified; what happens once a report is verified; how the AI spread prediction works and how reliable it is; how the system behaves when weather data or a live connection is unavailable; and what additional tools are available to firefighters.



18.4 Emergency Contacts

For life-threatening emergencies, the Help Menu prominently displays direct-dial emergency contact numbers, including the National Fire Emergency toll-free line (10177) and the City of Cape Town Fire & Rescue number (021 480 7700).

19 Change Log

Date	Version	Change
July 2026	1.0	Initial version (Demo 2)
August 2026	2.0	Reported Fires
September 2026	3.0	Admin Analytics+ Help Menu
October 2026	4.0	Wow Factors